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Attitude as a Predictor of Gender Education Among College Students

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ABSTRACT

It is fascinating to consider how deeply ingrained the initial thoughts and feelings about gender might influence our journey through gender education in college. This study explored the relationship between gender education and students' attitudes and behaviors related to gender concepts. Data analysis from various tables revealed that gender education positively impacts students' views on gender equality and their willingness to challenge gender stereotypes. The data showed a strong correlation between educational programs and support for gender equality, with students receiving more education demonstrating more progressive views. Moreover, the impact on core beliefs about gender roles seems less pronounced; the study suggests a nudge towards less traditional views. Interestingly, a potential link between a student's primary and willingness to address the gender gap emerged, with students in social sciences and humanities showing a slight positive correlation. Overall, the study concludes that gender education plays a significant role in shaping positive attitudes and potentially influencing actions that promote gender equality. Further research is recommended to explore the distinction of the relationship and investigate areas with less clear connections, such as the link between education and empowerment related to gender roles.

KEYWORDS

Gender education, descriptive-correlational gender equality, Frequency and Percentage, Mean, Pearson-r, gender roles, gender concepts, attitudes, stereotypes, behavior, willingness, and relationships, Philippines.

INTRODUCTION

Gender education and attitudes on gender concepts are worth studying since this can help the students understand how to promote gender equality in education and society. The Magna Carta of Women (Magna Carta) of 2009 is the encompassing Act that operationalizes the country's commitment to the CEDAW. The Magna Carta is the framework that guides and continues to guide efforts to legislate, implement, support, and program the gender equality efforts of government, civil society, and other stakeholders. It sets out the State's obligations in promoting and protecting gender equality, women's rights, and the promotion of female empowerment across all sectors of society.

In the Philippines (2023), Filipino women have biases against their gender because they think this is "natural or inevitable," according to women's rights. The study found that almost all, or 99.5% of Filipinos, held biases against women. Broken by gender, Filipino women who hold biases against their gender were just an increment higher, at 99.67%, compared to men with biases at 99.33% (Enriquez, 2023). The Act of 2013 prohibits discrimination based on sex, gender identity, or sexual orientation. It applies to all aspects of employment, education, and the provision of goods and services—Gender and Development (GAD) Law.

The Gender and Development (GAD) Law requires all government agencies to allocate a budget for programs and projects that promote gender equality and women's empowerment. This includes programs and projects that promote gender-critical education. Department of Education (DepEd) Order No. 49, s. 2017: DepEd Order No. 49, s. 2017 provides for implementing the Gender and Development (GAD) Law in the DepEd. Republic Act 9710. Zanghellini (2020) discusses philosophical problems with the gender-critical feminist argument against trans inclusion. On the other hand, Yildirim-Hamurcu and Terzioğlu (2023) explained attitudes toward dating violence among Turkish university students. The relationships between self-esteem level and gender roles. Moreover, Zajda (2022) discourses on Gender Inequality in Education.

Gender education on attitudes about gender concepts is a complex and controversial issue. Gender education is an approach to education that challenges traditional gender roles and stereotypes. It seeks to create a more inclusive and equitable learning environment for all students, regardless of gender identity or expression. Gender inequality is a stubbornly entrenched problem in Japan. It ranked 120 out of 156 countries in the World Economic Forum's Global Gender Gap Index (GGI) Report 2021, which measures the gap between men and women in political representation, economic empowerment, education, and health. This puts Japan at the bottom of the ladder among the developed world (Emma et al., 2022). In Davao, Philippines, 2022, *Constructions and Reconstructions of Masculinity Among Men in Gender Advocacy Groups*. The study examined the Men Opposed to Violence Everywhere (MOVE) Davao and Men's Responsibilities in Gender and Development (MR GAD) in Davao City, Philippines. A qualitative approach was used, and 16 participants were interviewed. It utilized the

perspective of social constructivism in analyzing men's constructions and reconstructions of masculinity (Villaroman, 2022).

In the context of SJIT Butuan City, gender equality has been challenged by several factors: a lack of creation of gender-sensitive schools and policies, weak school laws that did not annul gender biases, and the economic status of the student or parents. It seeks to create a more inclusive and equitable learning environment for all students. On the other hand, studies have shown that gender education can positively impact students' attitudes about gender equality. It is important to note that the research on the impact of gender-critical education is still in its early stages.

In addition to the above, Saint Joseph Institute of Technology offers a course, Gender and Society (GE-ELECT 2), for secondary students. CHED Memo No. 20, S. 2013 stated that Gender and Society should focus on "Gender as a social construction, its role in and impact on different facets of societal life. Gender and Society is a three-unit course that ignites awareness in students' understanding of our country's current problems in Gender inequality, Gender mainstreaming, and Gender preferences. It equips the students with a broader perspective on their gender roles as they discern stereotypes and discrimination dictated by society. It prepares students to be more gender-sensitive in words and actions as they build a new society filled with gender-responsive individuals.

FRAMEWORK

This study was anchored on the Gender Theory by de Beauvoir et al. (1949). Gender theory is a framework for understanding how gender is socially constructed and how it shapes our experiences and identities. It is a complex and nuanced field of study, but one of the critical concepts of gender theory, namely, firstly, is that gender is a social construct. This means that gender is not innate or biological but learned and performed through interactions with others. Secondly, there is a distinction between sex and gender. This explains that sex refers to our biological sex, while gender refers to our socially constructed sense of self as male, female, or something else. Thirdly, gender is not binary.

Discuss that there is a spectrum of gender identities, and people may identify as male, female, non-binary, gender-fluid, or something else. Lastly, gender is intersectional. This means that gender interacts with other factors, such as race, class, and sexuality, to shape our experiences.

Gender theory is relevant to many different areas of study, including sociology, psychology, anthropology, and education. It can be used to understand various phenomena, such as gender inequality, gender violence, and gender identity development. In addition, here are some examples of how gender theory can be applied. First, a sociologist might use gender theory to study how gender roles are constructed and maintained. Second, a psychologist might use gender theory to understand how gender identity develops in children. Third, an anthropologist might use gender theory to explore how gender norms and practices vary across cultures. Lastly, an educator might use gender theory to

develop more inclusive and equitable teaching practices. Gender theory is a valuable tool for understanding the complex and ever-changing nature of gender. It can be used to challenge traditional gender roles and norms and to promote gender equality and social justice.

Gender theory can also help to understand the potential impact of gender education on students. In addition, here is an example: gender theory suggests that gender-critical education can help students, too. Firstly, to develop a more critical understanding of gender roles and norms. Secondly, to challenge traditional gender stereotypes. Lastly, they are to become more aware of their own gender biases and become more supportive of gender equality. The research study on gender education and attitudes toward gender concepts among college students provided valuable information about the effectiveness of gender-critical education in promoting gender equality.

In addition, the study used gender theory to develop a framework for understanding how students experience gender education. The study used gender theory to identify the factors influencing students' attitudes toward gender concepts. The study used gender theory to develop recommendations for how to make gender education more effective. Overall, gender theory is a valuable tool for understanding the impact of gender education on college students' attitudes toward gender concepts. The research used gender theory to develop a more comprehensive understanding of the phenomenon and develop recommendations for making gender education more effective.

Figure 1 shows the framework of the study. The concept behind the framework of the study entitled "Gender education and attitude on gender concepts among college students" was designed to examine the relationship between gender education and attitudes on gender concepts. The independent variable was gender education, which was defined as education that teaches students about the social construction of gender and how gender inequality is perpetuated. The dependent variable was attitudes on gender concepts.

The framework identified the following key indicators of gender education: firstly, it was on knowledge. This referred to the student's understanding of gender theory and gender inequality. Secondly, it was on attitude. This discussed the students' positive or negative feelings towards gender equality. Thirdly was behavior. Fourthly was self-efficacy. This indicated the students' belief in their ability to make a difference in the fight for gender equality. Lastly, there was empowerment. This talked about the students' sense of control over their lives and ability to make their own choices.

The framework identified the following key indicators of attitudes on gender concepts, namely, the first was the belief about gender roles. This referred to students' beliefs about the roles and responsibilities of men and women. The second was on attitude towards gender stereotypes. This discussed the students' attitudes towards traditional gender stereotypes. The third was the support for gender equality. This talked through students' level of support for equal rights and opportunities for all people regardless of gender identity. Fourth was the willingness to challenge gender inequality. This was about students' willingness to

speak out against and take action to address gender inequality. The last was on behavioral intentions. This mentioned students' intentions to engage in behaviors that promote gender equality. In addition, the framework hypothesizes that gender-critical education can help students develop a deeper understanding of gender inequality and how it can be harmful. It can also help students develop the skills and confidence to challenge gender inequality and promote gender equality in their lives and the world around them.

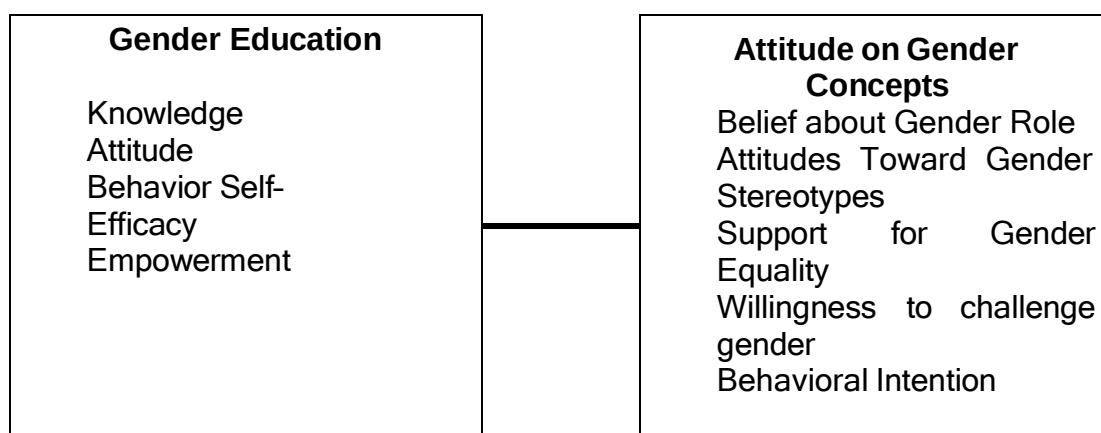


Figure 1. Schematic Diagram of the Study

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study is pursued to determine the following objectives: (1) to determine the level of perception of gender education among college students in terms of knowledge, attitudes, behavior, self-efficacy and empowerment; (2) to determine the extent of attitude on gender concepts among college students in terms of belief about gender roles, attitudes towards gender stereotypes, support for gender equality, willingness to challenge gender inequality, and behavioral intentions; (3) to evaluate significant relationship between the profile and level of perception of gender education, profile and extent of attitude towards gender concept and the level of gender perception and extent of attitude toward gender concepts.

METHODOLOGY

This study used a descriptive-correlational research design. The study's respondents were the Bachelor of Secondary Education Fourth-year students of Saint Joseph Institute of Technology. Thirty-one students served as respondents. Convenience sampling was used to select respondents. This study used an adapted survey questionnaire. The items of the survey questionnaire were taken from different sources. The tools that were used are Frequency and Percentage, Mean, and Pearson-r.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Table 1. Summary Table on The Level of Perception of Gender Education

Indicators	Overall Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
1. Knowledge	4.16	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as something other than the most significant factor shaping their views.
2. Attitude	4.34	Strongly Agree	Students may believe this type of education has dramatically influenced their perspectives on gender issues.
3. Behavior	4.14	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
4. Self-efficacy	4.07	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
5. Empowerment	4.10	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
Grand Mean	4.16	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but not see it as the most significant factor shaping their views.

Legend 4.21-5.00 Strongly Agree 3.41-4.20 Agree 2.61-3.40 Somewhat Agree 1.81-2.60 Disagree 1.00-1.80 Strongly Disagree

Table 1 shows a summary table on the level of perception of gender education. Students strongly agree on the attitude, meaning the impact on their feelings is more significant (4.34). This also has a verbal interpretation: "Students may believe this type of education has greatly influenced their perspectives on gender issues," consistent with research showing that students' views are significantly influenced (Rodriguez & Blaney, 2021).

Compared to other student responses, they agree on self-efficacy, though it got the lowest mean score (4.07). With a verbal interpretation: "Students may acknowledge the influence but may not see it as the most significant factor shaping their views." This suggests that, while students recognize the influence, it may extend beyond the practical. They may believe they can only use this knowledge in other educational settings (Barrineau, 2022).

On the other hand, an overall mean of 4.16 (agree) that gender education has informed their views on gender. With a verbal interpretation, "Students may acknowledge the influence but may not see it as the most significant factor shaping their views."

Table 2. Summary Table on the Extent of Attitudes on Gender Concept

Indicators	Overall Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
1. Beliefs about Gender Roles	3.19	Somewhat Agree	Students may recognize some impact, but there may be other factors they consider more influential.
2. Attitude Towards Gender Stereotypes	3.76	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
3. Support for Gender Equality	4.45	Strongly Agree	Students may believe this type of education has dramatically influenced their perspectives on gender issues.
4. Willingness to Challenge Gender Inequality	4.19	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
5. Behavioral Intentions	3.86	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.
Grand Mean	3.89	Agree	Students may acknowledge the influence but see it as less significant than the most significant factor shaping their views.

Legend 4.21-5.00 Strongly Agree 3.41-4.20 Agree 2.61-3.40 Somewhat Agree 1.81-2.60 Disagree 1.00-1.80 Strongly Disagree

Table 15 discusses the summary table on the extent of attitudes toward the gender concept. While students are committed to gender equality in general, which got the highest mean of 4.45 (strongly agree), interpreted as "Students may believe this type of education has greatly influenced their perspectives on gender issues." there seems to be some disagreement among them regarding the effectiveness of specific educational components. The category with the lowest score of 3.19 (somewhat agree) is interpreted as "Students may recognize some impact, but there may be other factors they consider more influential." Which is "Belief About Gender Role," which indicates a more nuanced perspective. While acknowledging the relevance of gender roles, students may prioritize other topics (Löffler & Greitemeyer, 2023).

The grand mean of 3.89 (agree) is interpreted as "Students may acknowledge the influence, but may not see it as the most significant factor shaping their views." This finding is congruent with a study by Lomazzi and Seddig (2020), which found that younger generations may still hold traditional attitudes but have progressive views on gender equality.

Table 3. Test of Correlation Between Gender, Education, and Attitude on Gender Concept

Gender Education		Beliefs about Gender Roles	Attitude Towards Gender Stereotypes	Support for Gender Equality	Willingness to Challenge Gender Inequality	Behavioral Intentions
Knowledge	Correlation Coefficient	-.0315	0.325	0.395	0.299	0.282
	P-Value	0.084	0.074	0.028	0.102	0.124
	Decision	Accept Null Hypothesis	Accept Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Accept Null Hypothesis	Accept Null Hypothesis
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Significant	Significant
Attitude	Correlation Coefficient	-0.212	0.440	0.676	0.580	0.519
	P-Value	0.254	0.013	0	0.001	0.003
	Decision	Accept Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis
	Interpretation	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
Behavior	Correlation Coefficient	-0.093	0.545	0.644	0.668	0.567
	P-Value	0.619	0.002	0	0	0.001
	Decision	Accept Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis
	Interpretation	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
Self-efficacy	Correlation Coefficient	-0.006	0.502	0.735	0.718	0.628
	P-Value	0.974	0.004	0	0	0
	Decision	Accept Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis
	Interpretation	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant

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Empowerment	Correlation Coefficient	-0.059	0.468	0.765	0.762	0.616
	P-Value	0.753	0.008	0	0	0
	Decision	Accept Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis	Reject Null Hypothesis
	Interpretation	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant

Correlation at the level of 0.05 (Two-tailed)

Analysis of the correlation data reveals that while gender education shows a statistically insignificant low negative correlation with traditional gender role beliefs (Child & Marvell, 2024), it exhibits statistically significant low to moderate positive correlations with attitudes challenging gender stereotypes (Lehmann-Grube et al., 2023), support for gender equality (Guo et al., 2024; Pedrajas & Jalandoni, 2023), willingness to challenge gender inequality, and behavioral intentions. Notably, support for gender equality demonstrates the strongest statistically significant positive association with gender education. These findings suggest that while gender education may not strongly impact deeply ingrained beliefs about gender roles, it does play a significant role in fostering attitudes that question stereotypes, promote gender equality, and encourage intentions to act against inequality.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that gender education plays a significant role in shaping students' perspectives and actions toward gender equality, despite existing gaps between understanding and practical application. Although students generally hold positive views about gender equality, their reservations regarding certain aspects of the course—particularly beliefs about gender roles—suggest that their attitudes are influenced by broader social and cultural factors beyond the classroom. While gender education shows minimal impact on deeply rooted gender role beliefs across age and sex groups, it remains a crucial driver of positive attitudes, motivating students to support equality, challenge inequality, and engage in meaningful actions. The proposed “Empowering Equality” program further demonstrates strong potential, as its student-centered and interactive strategies create an environment that can encourage deeper reflection, increased agency, and potential shifts in gender role perceptions. Its overall effectiveness, however, depends on careful implementation and ongoing evaluation to determine its influence on student attitudes and its broader impact on the community.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the results and findings of the study, it is recommended that administrators actively support and fund programs that not only provide knowledge but also cultivate positive attitudes, self-belief, and empowerment among students in promoting gender equality. The Office of the Student Affairs and Services (OSAS) should reinforce these efforts by endorsing educational initiatives that emphasize attitude formation and empowerment, recognizing that awareness alone is insufficient to inspire meaningful action. Program Heads are encouraged to guide instructors in integrating activities such as critical discussions, simulations, group projects, and action-planning tasks that strengthen students' confidence and commitment to gender equality. Teachers, in turn, should design learning experiences that foster critical thinking and empower students to believe in their capacity to contribute to positive change. Parents also play a vital role and are encouraged to maintain open conversations about gender equality at home to instill fairness and inclusivity from an early age. College students should broaden their understanding by exploring diverse sources of information and engaging respectfully with peers who hold differing viewpoints. Finally, future researchers are advised to further investigate the social and educational factors underlying gender-related attitudes and behaviors, contributing to a deeper understanding and more effective strategies for advancing gender equality.

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Challenges Among Students Towards Computer Subjects; A Phenomenological Study

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ABSTRACT

The study aims to describe and explore the challenges encountered by students in learning computer subjects. The researchers believed that learning computer subjects is necessary for transforming society by exposing the learners to existing technologies and empowering them with capacities to be the drivers of innovations for prosperity and sustainable development. However, there are still major barriers to this learning. This qualitative research has 10 participants who were selected BTVTED-CHS second-year and third-year students at the Philippine Electronic and Communication Institute of Technology to avoid biases, the participants were five males and five females. The participants are answered through one-on-one interviews with open-ended questions, the researchers used the phenomenological research design. It is best served to understand and describe the narratives of the students' experiences and feelings regarding this phenomenon. By focusing on the challenges they've encountered in computer studies toward discerning the issues and concerns the six themes are; the availability of tools, internet issues, gender issues, location, financial, and lack of skills. Finally, the study revealed that most of the participants have encountered a lot of general and personal challenges and there were seven (7) intervention programs presented; additional completely operational computer units, replacing and fixing the tools right away, renovating the computer laboratory with a bigger space and additional units, the school should provide to lend tools during a certain time, informing students on the first day of school regarding with the tools and equipment needed to equip them in saving money for the specific subjects, improving the school's internet connection especially in the laboratory, and offering free materials for preliminary tasks. This paper is a step to discern the challenges that were encountered by the present students and possibly by the future BTVTED-CHS students of PECIT.

KEYWORDS

Education, Challenges, Computer Studies, Phenomenological Research Design, Philippines

INTRODUCTION

For education to be relevant, it has to be responsive to the people's aspirations in society. It has been observed that science, technology, and innovation are key in addressing persistent gaps among developed and developing countries in access and use of existing technologies and developing innovations – and that this could be transformative in achieving sustainable development goals and producing more prosperous, sustainable, healthy and inclusive societies (UNCTAD, 2018).

This study aims to describe and explore the challenges encountered by students in learning computer subjects. The researchers believed that learning computer subjects is necessary for transforming society by exposing the learners to existing technologies and empowering them with capacities to be the drivers of innovations for prosperity and sustainable development. However, there are still major barriers to this learning. The researchers chose to study this topic to thoroughly discuss and understand these challenges.

Challenges related to adopting the e-learning system could be classified into four categories namely (1) technological challenges, (2) individual challenges, (3) cultural challenges, and (4) course challenges. These challenges are different from one country to another country, due to different cultures, contexts, and readiness. Lack of ICT knowledge, poor network infrastructure, and weakness in content development were the main challenges of e-learning system adoption in developing countries (Aung and Khaing 2015).

This study is founded on Dep Ed Order No. 78, s. 2010, entitled, Guidelines on the Implementation of the DepEd Computerization Program (DCP), as cited by Jarabese (2021). The DO aims to provide public schools with appropriate technologies that would enhance the teaching-learning process and meet the challenges of the 21st century. This program is said to provide ICT packages to public schools that are responsive to the needs of the K-12 curriculum, integrate ICT in the teaching and learning process, raise the ICT literacy of the students and the teachers, and improve the computer-to-student ratio in public schools.

Its legal mandate is to promote the right of all citizens to take appropriate steps in making education accessible to all, the department is geared towards the transformation of education through technology.

FRAMEWORK

The present study is anchored on the Self Determination Theory (SDT) by Ryan and Deci, 2000 cited by Salikhova et al. (2020). Self-determination theory (SDT) is a theory of motivation that suggests what is important is not simply the amount of motivation, but the quality of motivation a person has for activity in a specific domain (Ryan & Deci, 2017).

Digital education is a challenge not only for those who study, but also for those who teach. Sorebo et al. (2009) found that intrinsic motivation into account is useful in predicting teachers' intentions to continue using e-learning in their work with students. In addition to students, SDT was useful for explaining the effectiveness and for improving the online learning process for employees (Belkhamza & Bin Abdullah, 2019). Indeed, very often researchers turn to motivation issues, since it is known that the online learning environment requires a higher level of self-regulation, for which the quality and level of motivation are crucial (de Barba, Kennedy & Ainley, 2016; Buhr, Daniels & Goegan, 2019). Moreover, with respect to course completion, the role of internal motivation, in particular, has been emphasized (Barak, Watted & Haick, 2016). All this has led to the active use of self-determination theory (SDT) in the study of digital education (Ryan & Deci, 2017).

Applying Self-Determination Theory (SDT) to computer science education provides a worthy framework for educators to comprehend and resolve the issues of students, especially those from Bachelor of Technical-Vocational Teacher Education major in Computer Hardware Servicing (BTVTED-CHS). These issues consist of limited tool availability, internet connection problems, gender inequality, geographical location, economic factors, and lack of ability.

Researchers	Dean, College of Education, PECIT	President, PECIT	College Students of -Participants
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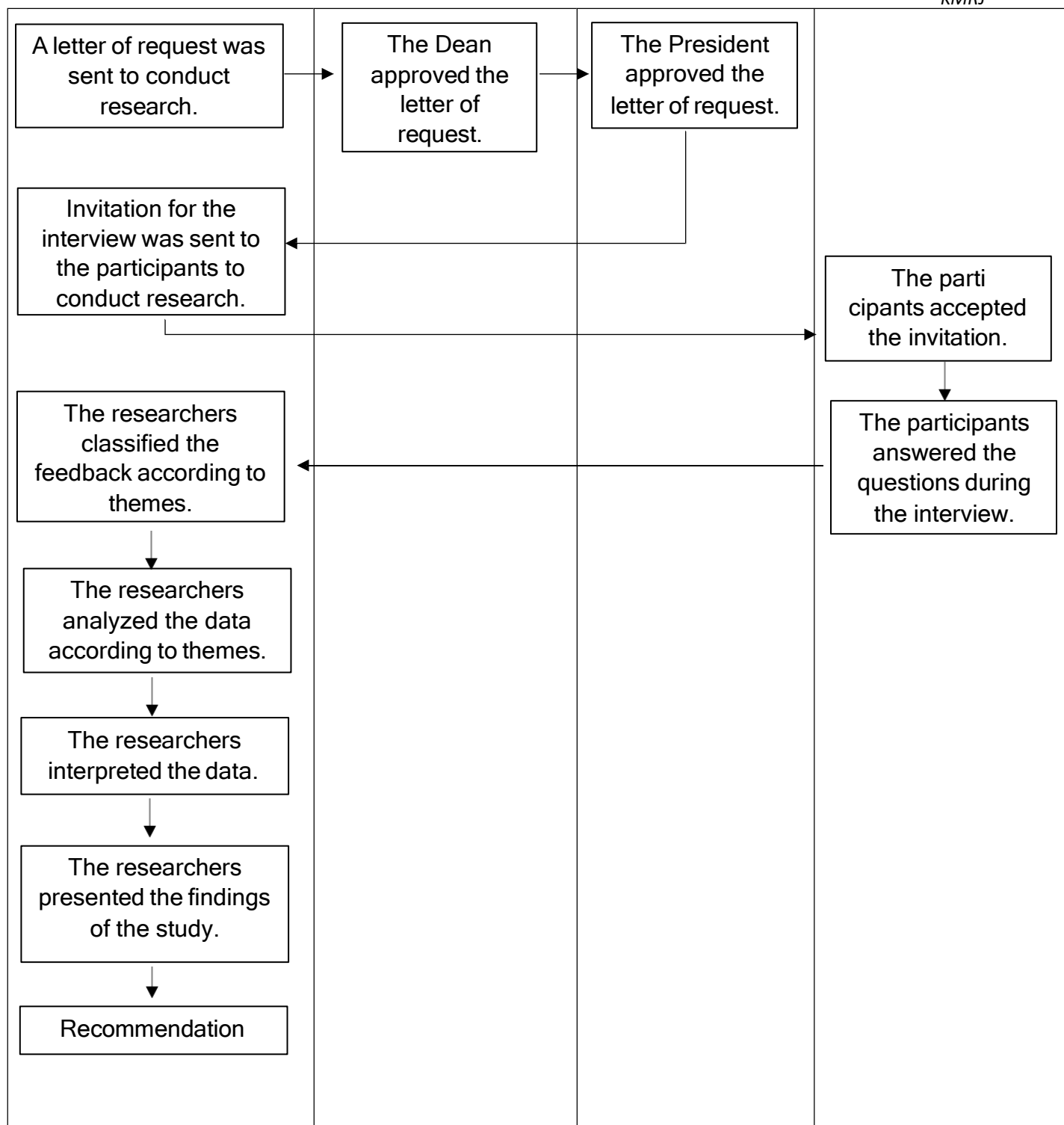


Figure 1: Flow of the Study

OBJECTIVE OF THE STUDY

The study pursued to determine the challenges encountered by the respondents in learning computer studies.

METHODOLOGY

The researchers used the phenomenological research design to collect the data to determine the challenges among students in computer courses. It is best to understand and describe the narratives of the students' experiences and feelings regarding this phenomenon. This study used the interview method to gather information. The researchers asked permission from the dean to interview on the school premises by writing a letter of consent. The researchers utilized a purposive sampling technique in choosing the respondents because this study was conducted to determine the challenges encountered by the respondents in learning computer studies at PECIT. A total of 10 participants were selected, five (5) females and five (5) males. The participants were second (2nd) year and third (3rd) year students of Bachelor in Technical Vocational Teacher Education Major in Computer Hardware Servicing (BTVTED-CHS) who were currently taking major subjects in this course. This study was conducted in the Philippine Electronics Communication Institute of Technology (PECIT) premises, located at Capitol-Bonbon Road Imadejas, Butuan City.

RESULT AND DISCUSSION

Table 1. *Availability of the Tools.*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Availability of Tools	Sometimes, the signal will be disrupted during calamities of loss of electricity. The school has an internet connection but it is log due to many users. Internet have negative effects especially being distracted on Tiktok, Facebook or even instagram. The internet connection of the school is very slow. Compare to other countries our internet connection here in the Philippines is very slow.	It is very advantageous to those students who have an internet connection at home which they can comfortably do their tasks at home. Using the internet too much may affect the studies. Students can practice their computer-related tasks at home if they have their materials and equipment.

Table 2. *Internet Issues*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Internet Issues	Sometimes, the signal will be disrupted during calamities of loss of electricity. The school has an internet connection but it is log due to many users. Internet have negative effects especially being distracted on Tiktok, Facebook or even Instagram. The internet connection of the school is very slow. Compare to other countries our internet connection here in the Philippines is very slow.	It is very advantageous to those students who have an internet connection at home which they can comfortably do their tasks at home. Using the internet too much may affect the studies. Students can practice their computer-related tasks at home if they have their materials and equipment.

Table 3. *Gender Issues*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Gender Issues	No pertaining issues in my gender in computer education. Treatment is fair in this course. No gender issues in the computer course. Based on the data gathered there was no gender discrimination in computer studies.	Computer studies do not rely on males only because I also have many female classmates. Some female students were better at computer studies than male. Computer studies do not depend on gender it relies on expertise. I can see that most of the experts in computers were males, and some were females. There is one student who agreed that computer studies are dominant for males because he is confident that he knows the safety and security

Table 4. *Location*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Location	It is an advantage if your house is far away and finances are insufficient because you also have projects and tuition. The school environment is affected because we are currently experiencing so much heat. If schools don't have proper ventilation, electric fans, or air conditioners, it can affect students' learning and may destroy computer units. Some stores offer the materials that we need but it is far from our school. Although there is some store near us, they sell it at a higher price. I'm forced to buy those expensive ones. The location is my main problem. Especially that our place have unstable internet connection. Because when we say computer studies it really involves internet connection. There are some rooms that don't have ceiling fans or air conditioners, and with the heat of the day, it's hard to study in this hot weather, but in our laboratory, there is an air conditioner, so many of my classmates can focus. When it comes to the difficulties I will focus on the room size because the room of the CSS lab is honestly I have seen it is very small but I already adjust with it.	If the students have a means of transportation, it will be easy for them to take computer courses despite the location's distance. Computer courses cannot be offered in the barrio because they don't have internet, computers and sometimes electricity is unstable. Therefore, students should consider the location. PECIT is an ideal place to take computer courses because we have supplies. We are near the city where we can buy the materials needed. As what I've seen there are students from other school that choose PECIT as their training center. The environment can affect students learning because if the computer gets dusty it can cause damage, if it's hot it can overheat. School environment is important for computer courses. There should be enough space for the computers and it should be air conditioned to avoid overheating of the computers. There is difficulties in terms of location in pursuing computer courses especially I'm a commuter, like when it rains, or the construction of the road here at school is very hassle, especially when I'm tired from work and I still need to walk to get to school, which is one of the reasons why I'm late for our class. The school should have proper access or have the proper parking area and also the school should have enough number of computers in order the students can be able to use.

Table 5. *Financial*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Financial	I don't have the tools because of financial matter. I cannot practice at home if tools are involved because I don't have it. It can affect the development of my skills. Taking computer course is very expensive, even just the computer itself is very expensive and you need two of it, a laptop, plus the tools. This course is very expensive. Taking computer courses is very expensive. Because if it is about computers the rate is much higher than the other courses that don't usually use it. But almost everything nowadays cost a lot. We cannot avoid especially if there are many materials needed in usage and the others were once to be used like RJ45, then in the next meeting you should buy another again. It is very important that a student or the school must have complete tools that can be used by the learners. Because if we don't have these tools there is a possibility that we cannot proceed in this course. We cannot develop our skills and learnings, which are the purpose why we study this course- to develop or level up our skills and learnings. There are times that my allowance is not enough especially if we will have an activity that day that involves the use of materials such as RJ45 and UTP cable. The difficulties that I've encountered in computer studies so far is the internet connection. Our house is located in a place where we experienced bad internet connection because of the area. It can be stressful and sometimes I get depressed then I feel weak when it comes to financial stability because I am the only	Well as a working student if I don't work then I cannot afford to pay my tuition, projects, and daily needs. So it is really an advantage if you have the means. Very expensive! First if you don't have money you can't enroll. Second if you don't have money for the materials needed you really can't proceed in this course, plus your daily needs. There is a possibility that you can't graduate. Being financially capable is important. Sometimes you can lose confidence when performing the activities if you know that you cannot buy all the materials needed. Not all can provide tools and equipment's because the other materials were so expensive just like computers and laptops. So it is fine that we are allowed to use it for our learning and for our skills to be enhanced. It is very important to be financially stable while taking the course so that we can buy the materials that is needed. Computer, laptop, and printer and then tools such as screwdrivers, testers, cables, and a lot more are most needed while taking the course. Your work will be done easier I you have your own materials, having those materials is very

one trying to provide for my schooling especially since I still have my children who are in elementary school. important so that you can do your work anytime.

Table 6. *Lack of Skills*

THEMES	ISSUES	CONCERNS
Lack of Skills	Taking computer course with literacy is very advantage to be honest it's a big help but I don't really have good knowledge when it comes to digital literacy that's why I took this course because I want to enhance and I'm willing to learn. If you don't have stock knowledge it will be difficult to understand your discussions. Computer/digital literacy skills really essential. Especially in this crowded time, we have technologies that are really aligned with my course that I am taking now that can help me succeed. You need to learn the basic skills of your course or field. You must what are the basic skill that you must know before you choose a course. Later on, if you're already on that field your level of learning will be developed. In terms of computer the basic skills that you must know are the assemble and disassemble, Networking, server configuration, and backup	The eager to learn is a challenge for me since I am old and I have the skills so I can perform the assessment tasks in the course. It is very necessary to have a prior knowledge because computer or technical skill is not a quite kind of a job. It has high risk in electricity. You really need to have proper knowledge because you're expected to perform something that involves electricity. If you have less knowledge you're at risk of danger so it is necessary for us to have knowledge about this for our safety and for the safety of the people surrounding, you. I'll rate myself from 1-10 in to 5 because since I don't have not yet much knowledge within this course and it affects my performance in computer studies. I realize that we must have knowledge when it comes to computer studies so that we don't have that difficulties. Then if we have that, it's easy for us to apply and to our individual as well. Just being a hardworking guy and having a good courage and extreme learning how to finish all my tasks and I think those are the skills I need to help me succeed. I have a bit of knowledge before I go enter this course and that could make me easy to perform the task and believe me or not the task it is necessary to have that. Those digital proficiency skills will not be difficult for you when you encounter something. If you're a computer literate, if you have prior experience about computer then it is really an advantage for you. But if not then you really

and restore. All of those are based on the standard of the TESDA NCII.

need some help and you need to study hard. Know the basic theory and basic fundamentals that you need to know in order to perform your tasks. Me, before I enrolled in this course I've successfully finished a technical vocational course that is also connected to computers so I have an advantage on that part. This is more likely a mastery of what I've study before.

CONCLUSIONS

BTVTED-CHS students have gone through a lot of general and personal challenges that hinder in developing their computer knowledge and skills. The participants were trying their best to meet those challenges and plan initiatives despite their situation. Those challenges made them better problem solvers and helped in developing their skills.

Thus, the school and the government must look after those problems and implement an intervention that will help in solving the general challenges that have been encountered by the students.

RECOMMENDATIONS

In light of the outcomes and conclusions presented in this study, it is recommended that PECIT administrators take a proactive role in understanding the specific challenges experienced by students on campus and develop targeted interventions that can effectively address these concerns. Families are encouraged to continue providing emotional support, motivation, and guidance to help students navigate difficulties and stay resilient throughout their academic journey. Teachers should foster a positive and supportive classroom environment by identifying and helping alleviate the challenges that hinder students' learning and engagement. Lastly, future researchers are encouraged to use this study as a foundational reference as they explore deeper insights into coping mechanisms and strategies that can effectively respond to the challenges faced by computer studies students, ultimately contributing to improved student well-being and academic success.

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Customer Service and Product Variety on Customer Satisfaction

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ABSTRACT

The connection between the variety of products offered and the quality of customer service provided with the resulting satisfaction levels of patrons at Kitty's Snack Corner. This study investigated the relationship between the product variety and customer service on customer satisfaction at Kitty's Snack Corner in Libertad, Butuan City. A descriptive correlational research design was employed to gather data from 100 customers using a convenient sampling technique, was used questionnaire to utilize as the research instrument, and the data were analyzed using Mean, Frequency/Percentage, and Pearson correlation. The study found that Kitty's Snack Corner is successfully meeting the needs and expectations of its customers. The establishment's focus on product variety, quality, and customer service has contributed to high levels of customer satisfaction. To maintain and enhance customer satisfaction, Kitty's Snack Corner may continue to prioritize these key areas. By offering a diverse range of high-quality products, providing excellent customer service, and fostering a positive dining experience, the establishment can strengthen its position in the market and attract loyal customers.

Keywords: Business Administration, availability, communication, customer satisfaction, customer service, efficiency, freshness, friendliness, follow-up, knowledge, personalization, product variety, pricing, quality, responsiveness, uniqueness, descriptive-correlational design, Philippines.

INTRODUCTION

The study is crucial for several reasons. First, it contributes to the existing body of knowledge on customer satisfaction within the food service industry (Alonzo & Delos Santos, 2021). Understanding the factors that influence customer satisfaction can help businesses like Kitty's Snack Corner improve their operations and enhance customer loyalty. Second, the study can provide valuable insights for other food service establishments in the Philippines, enabling them to implement strategies that lead to greater customer satisfaction and success. Finally, the findings of this research can contribute to the development of evidence-based policies and guidelines related to customer service and product variety in the food industry (Cabrera & Manansala, 2023).

The study is anchored on various legal frameworks that govern the operations of credit cooperatives in the Philippines. The Cooperative Code of the Philippines (Republic Act No. 9520) provides the overarching legal framework for the establishment, organization, and operation of cooperatives in the country (Cooperative Development Authority, 2023). Within this context, credit cooperatives are subject to specific regulations and guidelines issued by the Cooperative Development Authority (CDA), the government agency tasked with overseeing the cooperative sector (CDA Memorandum Circular No. 2022-01). These legal provisions ensure that credit cooperatives adhere to sound financial practices and promote the interests of their members.

The study aligns with several Philippine laws and regulations that promote consumer protection and fair business practices. The Consumer Act of the Philippines (Republic Act No. 7394) mandates that businesses provide goods and services of acceptable quality and safety (Department of Trade and Industry, 2022). Furthermore, the Fair Trade Act (Republic Act No. 10667) prohibits unfair and deceptive business practices, including misleading advertising and false representations about product quality or customer service (Philippine Competition Commission, 2019). By examining the relationship between product variety, customer service, and customer satisfaction, this study contributes to ensuring that businesses like Kitty's Snack Corner adhere to these legal requirements and uphold consumer rights.

Limited Studies on the Combined Influence of Product Variety and Customer Service in Snack Corners While numerous studies have examined the impact of product variety and customer service on customer satisfaction in various industries, research specifically focusing on snack corners remains limited (Chen & Lin, 2021). This gap highlights the need for a more tailored investigation into the unique dynamics of this particular retail segment.

Insufficient Exploration of Customer Expectations and Preferences in Snack Corners Existing studies often overlook the specific expectations and preferences of customers frequenting snack corners (Wang & Zhang, 2023). Understanding these unique preferences is crucial for developing effective strategies to enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty.

Lack of Research on Customer Satisfaction in Local Snack Corners While studies on customer satisfaction have been conducted in various industries within the Philippines, research focused on local snack corners is scarce (Alonzo & Delos Santos, 2021) This gap limits our understanding of the specific factors influencing customer satisfaction in this unique retail environment.

Limited Data on Customer Satisfaction in Snack Corners in Butuan city despite the growing popularity of snack corners in Butuan city, there is a lack of empirical research examining customer satisfaction levels within this specific locality (Cabrera & Manansala 2023) This gap underscores the need for localized studies to inform targeted strategies for improving customer experiences.

The study is essential for marketing students pursuing a Business Administration degree. By examining the factors that contributed to customer satisfaction within the food service industry, this research aligned with the core principles of marketing, which focus on understanding customer needs, preferences, and behaviors. This study provided a valuable opportunity for students to apply their theoretical knowledge to a real-world business context and gained practical insights into the importance of product variety and customer service in driving customer loyalty and satisfaction. Moreover, the findings of this research can contribute to the development of evidence-based marketing strategies that can be implemented by businesses in the food service industry, both locally and nationally.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study sought to Identify the following objectives: (1) to determine the Profile respondents' Profile in terms of Age, and Sex; (2) to determine the level of perception on product variety in terms of uniqueness, quality, freshness, and pricing; (3) to determine the level of perception on customer service in terms of responsiveness, communication, efficiency, and personalization; (4) to determine the degree of customer satisfaction in terms of product, service, loyalty, and retention; (5) to determine the significant relationship between the profile respondents' and level of perception on product variety, profile respondents' and level of perception on customer service, profile respondents' and degree of customer satisfaction, level of perception on product variety and the degree of customer Satisfaction and level of perception on customer service and the degree of customer satisfaction.

METHODOLOGY

This study utilized a descriptive-correlational research design to investigate the influence of product variety and customer service on customer satisfaction at Kitty's

Snack Corner. The descriptive aspect involved profiling respondents by age and sex, detailing their perceived levels of product variety (uniqueness, quality, freshness, and pricing) and customer service (responsiveness, communication, efficiency, and personalization), and assessing their degree of customer satisfaction (product, service, loyalty, and retention). The correlational aspect aimed to determine the significant relationships between demographic profile and product variety perception; demographic profile and customer service perception; demographic profile and customer satisfaction; product variety perception and customer service perception; product variety perception and customer satisfaction; and customer service perception and customer satisfaction. This design was chosen because it allows for the description of these variables and the examination of their co-occurrence and potential associations without any manipulation. Data was collected using a survey questionnaire adapted from Alonzo and Delos Santos (2021), comprising four sections: demographics, perception of product variety, perception of customer service, and degree of customer satisfaction. The study aimed to understand how product variety and customer service influence customer satisfaction at the specific snack corner by analyzing existing relationships.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Problem 1. What is the profile respondents in terms of Age and Sex?

Table 1

Distribution of Respondents' profile in terms of Age

Age	Frequency	Percentage
17below	37	37%
18-25	30	30%
26-35	25	25%
36above	8	8%
Total	100	100%

Distribution of Respondents' in terms of Sex

Sex	Frequency	Percentage
Male	54	54%
Female	46	46%
Total	100	100%

Table 1 reveals the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of age and sex. The majority of the respondents was aged 17 or below (37%), followed by those aged 18-25 (30%) and 26-35 (25%). Only a small percentage of respondents were 36

years old or older (8%). And highlights the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of sex. The results show that the sample is relatively evenly split between male (54%) and female (46%) respondents.

Problem 2. What is the level of perception on product variety in terms of

Table 2

Summary table of Product Variety

	Statement	Mean	Verbal Description
1	Uniqueness	4.34	Strongly Agree
2	Quality	4.69	Strongly Agree
3	Freshness	4.72	Strongly Agree
4	Pricing	4.58	Strongly Agree
Grand-total Mean		4.58	Strongly Agree

Legend: 1.0-1.80 Strongly Disagree; 1.81-2.60 Disagree; 2.61-3.40 Neutral; 3.41-4.20 Agree; 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree

Table 2 titled "Summary table of Product Variety" reveals a summary of the perceived product variety at Kitty's Snack Corner. The table shows that respondents have a high overall perception of product variety, with all dimensions (uniqueness, quality, freshness, and pricing) receiving strong agreement ratings. The highest mean score of 4.72 was obtained for "Freshness," indicating that customers highly value the freshness of the products offered. This is crucial in the food service industry, as freshness is often associated with quality and taste. The lowest mean score of 4.34 was obtained for "Uniqueness," suggesting that while customers perceive the products as unique, there may be room for further differentiation and innovation. Overall, the grand total mean of 4.58 indicates a high level of customer satisfaction with the product variety offered by Kitty's Snack Corner. This finding aligns with previous research by Chen and Lin (2021), who found that product variety, is a key driver of customer satisfaction in the fast-food industry. By offering a diverse range of high-quality, fresh, and unique products, Kitty's Snack Corner can attract and retain customers, and enhance its brand reputation.

Problem 3. What is the level of perception on customer service in terms of

Table 3

Summary table of Customer Service

	Statement	Mean	Verbal Description
1	Responsiveness	4.72	Strongly Agree
2	Communication	4.72	Strongly Agree
3	Efficiency	4.68	Strongly Agree
4	Personalization	4.67	Strongly Agree
Grand total Mean		4.69	Strongly Agree

Legend: 1.0-1.80 Strongly Disagree; 1.81-2.60 Disagree; 2.61-3.40 Neutral; 3.41-4.20 Agree; 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree

Table 3 reveals a summary of customer service. The table shows that respondents have a high overall perception of customer service, with all dimensions (responsiveness, communication, efficiency, and personalization) receiving strong agreement ratings. The highest mean scores of 4.72 were obtained for "Responsiveness" and "Communication," indicating that customers highly value the promptness and clarity of the staff's interactions. The lowest mean score of 4.67 was obtained for "Personalization," suggesting that while customers generally perceive the service to be personalized, there may be room for further improvement in tailoring the service to individual needs. Overall, the grand total mean of 4.69 indicates a high level of customer satisfaction with the service provided by Kitty's Snack Corner. This finding aligns with previous research by Wang and Zhang (2023), who found that customer service quality is a critical factor in driving customer satisfaction. By maintaining high levels of customer service, Kitty's Snack Corner can enhance customer loyalty and positive word-of-mouth.

Problem 4. What is the degree of customer satisfaction in terms of:

Table 4

Summary table of Customer Satisfaction

	Statement	Mean	Verbal Description
1	Product	4.82	Strongly Agree
2	Service	4.82	Strongly Agree
3	Loyalty	4.62	Strongly Agree
4	Retention	4.67	Strongly Agree
Grand total Mean		4.73	Strongly Agree

Legend: 1.0-1.80 Strongly Disagree; 1.81-2.60 Disagree; 2.61-3.40 Neutral; 3.41-4.20 Agree; 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree

Table 4 presents a summary of overall customer satisfaction. The table shows that respondents have a high level of overall satisfaction with Kitty's Snack Corner. The highest mean scores of 4.82 were obtained for "Product" and "Service," indicating that customers are highly satisfied with both the products offered and the service provided. The lowest mean score of 4.62 was obtained for "Loyalty," suggesting that while customers are generally loyal, there may be room for improvement in fostering deeper emotional connections. Overall, the grand total mean of 4.73 indicates a high level of overall customer satisfaction. This finding aligns with previous research by Chen and Lin (2021), who found that product quality, variety, and customer service are key drivers of customer satisfaction. By maintaining high standards in these areas, Kitty's Snack Corner can continue to attract and retain customers and enhance its brand reputation.

Problem 5. Correlation Analysis Between Customer Service and Customer Satisfaction

Table 5

Indicators		Product	Service	Loyalty	Retention
Uniqueness	Correlation Coefficient	0.017	0.186	0.368	0.467
	P- Value	0.289	0.063	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Accepted	Accepted	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Not Significant	Significant	Significant
Quality	Correlation Coefficient	0.347	0.311	0.425	0.480
	P- Value	0.001	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
Freshness	Correlation Coefficient	0.430	0.258	0.369	0.396
	P- Value	0.001	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Pricing	Correlation Coefficient	0.380	0.378	0.611	0.639
	P- Value	0.001	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant

* Correlational at the level of 0.05 (Two-tailed)

Table 5. Titled “Correlation Analysis between Customer service and customer Satisfaction”. The correlation analyses reveal varying degrees of positive relationships between different aspects of product variety and customer satisfaction. Regarding product uniqueness, a low positive correlation exists with overall customer satisfaction, with statistically significant relationships specifically observed for customer loyalty and retention. This suggests that offering unique products can contribute to increased customer loyalty and a higher likelihood of customers returning. In terms of product quality, a low yet statistically significant positive correlation is evident across all dimensions of customer satisfaction, indicating that higher perceived product quality enhances satisfaction with the product itself, the service received, and the overall customer experience. Similarly, product freshness demonstrates a low to very low but statistically significant positive correlation with all facets of customer satisfaction, implying

that customers are more satisfied when they perceive the products as fresh. Finally, product pricing, specifically the perceived value for money, shows a low to moderate and statistically significant positive correlation with all dimensions of customer satisfaction. This highlights the importance of offering products that customers feel are worth their price, as it positively influences their satisfaction with the product, service, and overall experience. These findings collectively underscore the importance of various product attributes in driving customer satisfaction, aligning with previous research that identifies uniqueness, quality, freshness, and perceived value as key factors.

Problem 6. Correlation Analysis Between Product Variety and Customer Satisfaction

Table 6

Indicators		Product	Service	Loyalty	Retention
Responsiveness	Correlation Coefficient	0.533	0.591	0.685	0.667
	P- Value	0.001	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Communication	Correlation Coefficient	0.245	0.225	0.421	0.404
	P- Value	0.014	0.024	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Efficiency	Correlation Coefficient	0.335	0.336	0.548	0.480
	P- Value	0.001	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Personalization	Correlation Coefficient	0.301	0.359	0.561	0.591
	P- Value	0.002	0.001	0.001	0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant

* Correlational at the level of 0.05 (Two-tailed)

Table 6. Titled “Correlation Analysis Between Product Variety and Customer Satisfaction”. The analysis of customer service dimensions reveals significant positive correlations with customer satisfaction across various aspects. Customer service responsiveness demonstrates a moderate positive impact, indicating that prompt and attentive service strongly contributes to overall customer satisfaction. Similarly, the effective communication skills of the staff show a low positive correlation with customer satisfaction, suggesting that clear and helpful communication enhances customer experience. Furthermore, customer service efficiency exhibits a low to moderate positive

correlation with customer satisfaction, highlighting the importance of timely and streamlined service delivery. Lastly, personalized service also presents a low to moderate positive correlation with customer satisfaction, indicating that tailoring the service to individual customer needs can lead to greater satisfaction and foster loyalty and retention. These findings collectively underscore the critical role of various customer service attributes in shaping customer satisfaction, aligning with previous research that emphasizes responsiveness, communication, efficiency, and personalization as key drivers of a positive customer experience.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that Kitty's Snack Corner successfully caters to a predominantly young market, attracting both male and female customers equally. The establishment's diverse selection of products—recognized for their uniqueness, quality, freshness, and reasonable pricing—combined with the responsive, well-trained, and customer-oriented staff, contributes to a high level of customer satisfaction. The results further indicate that age and gender do not significantly influence customers' satisfaction with product variety, customer service, or overall experience, suggesting that the business appeals broadly across demographic groups. Moreover, the positive relationship between perceived product variety, customer service quality, and customer satisfaction highlights the importance of maintaining diverse offerings and excellent service. Overall, Kitty's Snack Corner demonstrates strong performance in both product delivery and service quality, leading to consistently high customer satisfaction.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the conclusions of the study, it is recommended that the business owner continue to strengthen customer satisfaction by consistently prioritizing product variety, quality, and service excellence, as these factors have been proven to significantly enhance customer experiences. Other snack businesses in Butuan City and nearby areas may also adopt these insights to improve their operations and competitiveness, particularly by focusing on diverse offerings and responsive customer service. For customers, the study provides valuable understanding of the elements that shape their satisfaction, empowering them to make informed choices and engage more meaningfully with food establishments.

Lastly, future researchers are encouraged to use this study as a foundation for further exploration of customer satisfaction within the food service industry, contributing to a deeper understanding of consumer behavior and supporting continuous improvement in the sector.

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Students' Perception of Innovation and Entrepreneurial Ventures

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ABSTRACT

This study investigated the perception of Bachelor of Science in Business Administration students at Philippine Electronics & Communication Institute of Technology, Butuan City, on innovation and entrepreneurial ventures. A descriptive correlational research design was employed to explore the relationship between various factors, such as creativity, risk tolerance, and leadership, and their impact on entrepreneurial intent. A purposive sampling technique was used to select 100 BSBA students from the first to fourth-year levels, with 25 students randomly selected from each year level using a fishbowl method. A survey questionnaire was used to gather the data. Frequency and Percentage, Mean, and Pearson-r were used in the data analysis. The findings revealed that BSBA students exhibited a strong inclination towards innovation, particularly in creativity, risk tolerance, leadership, and intellectual property rights, but showed a slightly lower perception of responsiveness to opportunities, highlighting the need for more exposure to market-driven innovation. Additionally, students demonstrated high entrepreneurial intent, especially in scalability and financial planning, yet faced challenges related to market size and demand, indicating the necessity for practical experience in market research and customer acquisition. A significant positive correlation was found between students' perception of innovation and their entrepreneurial ventures, particularly in creativity, risk-taking, and leadership, suggesting that fostering an innovative mindset can enhance their likelihood of pursuing entrepreneurial activities. The study concludes with recommendations for educational institutions and policymakers to foster a more entrepreneurial mindset among students.

Keywords: *entrepreneurial ventures, innovation, intellectual property right, leadership, passion and interest, responsiveness to opportunities, scalability, tolerance of risk, descriptive-correlational design, Philippines*

INTRODUCTION

Innovation in entrepreneurial ventures as perceived by Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) students is crucial for several reasons. First, it provides valuable insights into the mindset and understanding of future entrepreneurs regarding the significance of innovation in business success. By examining the perspectives of Bachelor of Science in Business Administration students, the study can identify areas where educational institutions and policymakers can focus on fostering a more innovative entrepreneurial ecosystem (Abalos and Garcia, 2021). Second, the findings of this research can contribute to the development of targeted interventions and programs to enhance entrepreneurial skills and knowledge, particularly in the realm of innovation. By understanding the specific needs and perceptions of BSBA students, educators can tailor their curriculum and support services to better equip them for the challenges and opportunities of entrepreneurship (Santos and Rodriguez, 2023).

The study on innovation in entrepreneurial ventures aligns with various Philippine laws and policies that promote entrepreneurship and innovation. The Philippine Development Plan (PDP) 2023-2028, for example, identifies entrepreneurship as a key driver of economic growth and development. The PDP emphasizes the need to foster a conducive environment for entrepreneurship, including access to financing, markets, and skills development (National Economic and Development Authority, 2023). Additionally, the Republic Act No. 10579, also known as the Innovative Start-up Act, provides incentives and support for startups and innovation-driven enterprises. This law aims to create a favorable ecosystem for innovation and entrepreneurship encouraging the development of new products, services, and technologies (DTI, 2020).

At the international level, studies have consistently highlighted a disparity between the perceived importance of innovation and its actual implementation in entrepreneurial ventures (Lin and Wu, 2021). While innovation is often recognized as a critical factor for success, many entrepreneurs face challenges in effectively integrating innovative practices into their businesses (Chen and Wang, 2020). Additionally, there is a growing concern about the adequacy of entrepreneurial education programs in fostering innovative mindsets and skills among aspiring entrepreneurs (Lee and Kim, 2022).

Furthermore, the international landscape reveals a lack of standardized frameworks and support systems for nurturing innovation in entrepreneurial ventures (Zhang and Li, 2019). While some countries have made significant strides in creating innovation ecosystems, others continue to struggle with limited access to funding, mentorship, and research facilities (Huang and Chen, 2023). This disparity in support infrastructure can hinder the growth and development of innovative entrepreneurial ventures, particularly in regions with limited resources (Ma and Liu, 2021).

In this context, research has identified several gaps in the entrepreneurial innovation ecosystem. While there has been a growing interest in entrepreneurship and innovation, the country's infrastructure and support systems for start-ups and small businesses remain underdeveloped (Dizon and Cruz, 2020). This has resulted in challenges for entrepreneurs in accessing funding, mentorship, and market opportunities (Abalos and Garcia, 2021). Additionally, there is a need for more targeted interventions to address the specific needs of entrepreneurs in different regions and industries, as well as to promote collaboration and knowledge sharing among entrepreneurs (Santos and Rodriguez, 2023).

In the context of Butuan City, there may be a gap in the quality and relevance of entrepreneurial innovation education programs offered by local institutions. While there may be existing entrepreneurship courses, they may not adequately address the unique challenges and opportunities faced by entrepreneurs in the region. This could result in a lack of preparedness among aspiring entrepreneurs to effectively leverage innovation in their ventures. Furthermore, there may be limited opportunities for entrepreneurs to engage in mentorship, networking, and collaborative activities that can foster innovation and growth.

This study on the role of innovation in entrepreneurial ventures as perceived by BSBA students is crucial in the context of business research and marketing management education. By examining the perspectives of future entrepreneurs, the study can contribute to a deeper understanding of the factors that drive innovation in entrepreneurial ventures and the challenges that entrepreneurs face in implementing innovative strategies. This knowledge can be valuable for business educators in designing and delivering an effective curriculum that equips students with the necessary skills and competencies to become successful entrepreneurs. Additionally, the study can inform policymakers and industry leaders about the specific needs and priorities of entrepreneurs in the region, facilitating the development of targeted support programs and initiatives to foster innovation and entrepreneurship. Overall, this research has the potential to make a significant contribution to the field of business research and to support the development of a more vibrant and innovative entrepreneurial ecosystem in the Philippines.

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

This study was anchored on the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) (Ajzen, 1991). The TPB posits that individuals' intentions to perform a behavior are influenced by their attitudes towards the behavior, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control. Attitudes refer to the individual's positive or negative evaluation of the behavior, subjective norms pertain to the perceived social pressure to perform or not perform the behavior, and perceived behavioral control reflects the individual's belief in their ability to perform the behavior.

The TPB is relevant to this study because it provides a framework for understanding the factors that influence BSBA students' intentions to engage in innovative entrepreneurial activities. By examining their attitudes towards innovation, perceived social norms, and perceived behavioral control, we can gain insights into the factors that drive or hinder their entrepreneurial innovation behavior.

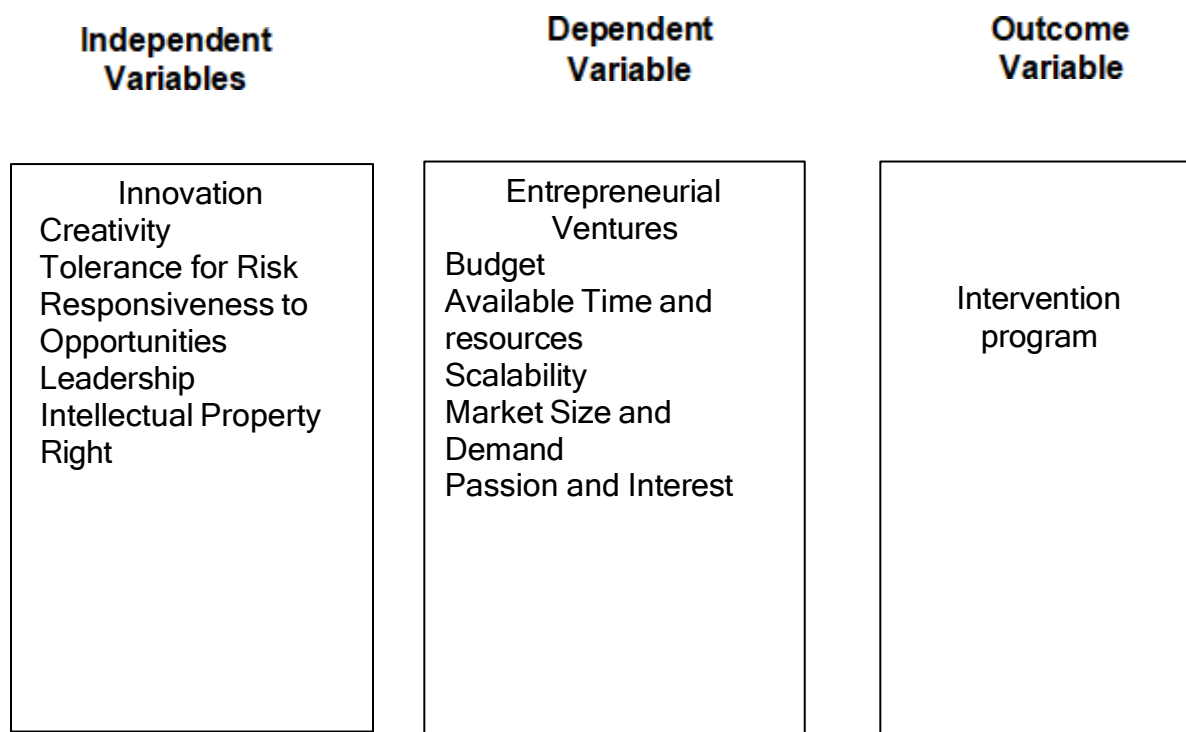


Figure1. Research Paradigm

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study sought to determine the following objectives: (1) to classify the perceived level of innovation in terms of creativity, tolerance for risk, responsiveness to opportunities, leadership, and Intellectual property right. (2) to determine the extent of entrepreneurial ventures in terms of budget, available time and resources, scalability, market size and demand; and Passion and interest. (3) to find the significant relationship between the level of perception and the extent of entrepreneurial ventures.

METHODOLOGY

A descriptive correlational research design was employed to explore the relationship between various factors, such as creativity, risk tolerance, and leadership, and their impact on entrepreneurial intent. A purposive sampling technique was used to select 100 BSBA students from the first to fourth-year levels, with 25 students randomly selected from each year level using a fishbowl method. A survey questionnaire was used

to gather the data. Frequency and Percentage, Mean, and Pearson-r were used in the data analysis.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Table 1

Summary Table on the Perceived Level of Innovation

Variables	Mean	Verbal Description
Creativity	4.34	Always
Tolerance for Risk	4.36	Always
Responsiveness to Opportunities	4.32	Always
Leadership	4.44	Always
Intellectual Property	4.38	Always
Grand Mean	4.37	Always

Legend: 4.21-5.0 Always, 3.41-4.20 Often, 2.61-3.40 Sometimes, 1.81-2.60 Seldom, 1.0-2.80 Never

Table 1 presents the summary table on the perceived level of innovation. It has a total weighted mean (4.37) with a verbal interpretation of Always. Across the variables, Leadership has the highest mean of 4.44 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that the respondents believe in the importance of leadership in driving innovation. Followed by the intellectual property mean of 4.38 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied a strong belief in the transformative power of innovation through intellectual property rights. Next, the tolerance for risk means 4.36 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents are willing to embrace uncertainty and take calculated risks in pursuit of their entrepreneurial goals. In creativity mean of 4.34 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents value creativity and its role in innovation. Additionally, the responsiveness to opportunities has the lowest mean of 4.32 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents are aware of the importance of identifying and capitalizing on new opportunities (Costa et al., 2023).

Table 2

Summary Table on the Extent of Entrepreneurial Ventures

Variable	Mean	Verbal Description
Budget	4.34	Always
Available Time and Resources	4.34	Always
Scalability	4.39	Always
Market Size and Demand	4.22	Always
Passion and Interest	4.26	Always
Grand Mean	4.31	Always

Legend: 4.21-5.0 Always, 3.41-4.20 Often, 2.61-3.40 Sometimes, 1.81-2.60 Seldom, 1.0-2.80 Never

Table 2 presents the summary table on the extent of entrepreneurial ventures. Scalability has the highest mean of 4.39 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that the respondents have a positive outlook and belief in the scalability of ventures. Followed by the budget and availability time and resources mean of 4.34 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents have a strong belief in the importance of various factors for entrepreneurial success and the potential of social innovation to address societal challenges and create a positive impact. Next the passion and interest mean of 4.26 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents completely agree on the extent of entrepreneurial ventures in terms of passion and interest. Additionally, the responsiveness to opportunities has the lowest mean of 4.22 with a verbal description of “Always” and a verbal interpretation of “The respondent completely agrees to the statement”. This implied that respondents completely agree on the extent of entrepreneurial ventures in terms of market size and demand.

Table 3

Correlation Analysis: Between Innovation and Entrepreneurial Ventures

Indicator		Budget	Available Time and Resources	Scalability	Market Size and Demand	Passion and Interest
Creativity	Correlation Coefficient	0.555	0.502	0.025	0.045	0.091
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.805	0.657	0.368
	Decision	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
	Interpretation	Reject	Reject	Accept	Accept	Accept
Tolerance of Risk	Correlation Coefficient	0.621	0.437	0.019	0.016	0.146
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.851	0.874	0.147
	Decision	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
	Interpretation	Reject	Reject	Accept	Accept	Accept
Responsiveness to Opportunities	Correlation Coefficient	0.640	0.622	0.020	0.266	0.045
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.843	0.007	0.657
	Decision	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Significant	Not Significant
	Interpretation	Reject	Reject	Accept	Reject	Accept
Leadership	Correlation Coefficient	0.659	0.479	0.099	0.106	0.021
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.327	0.294	0.836
	Decision	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
	Interpretation	Reject	Reject	Accept	Accept	Accept
Intellectual property right	Correlation Coefficient	0.622	0.530	0.210	0.001	0.080
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.036	0.992	0.429
	Decision	Significant	Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant

						KMRJ
	Interpretation	Reject	Reject	Reject	Accept	Accept

**Correlational at the level of 0.05 (Two-tailed)*

Table 3 reveals the significant relationship between innovation and entrepreneurial ventures. The data above showed that there is no significant relationship between creativity and entrepreneurial ventures in terms of scalability, market size and demand, and passion and interest. While there is a significant relationship between budget and available time and resources. This emphasizes the significance of practical factors like budget and available resources in fostering innovation (Wabwezi, 2011). The data above showed that there is no significant relationship between tolerance of risk and entrepreneurial ventures in terms of scalability, market size and demand, and passion and interest. While there is a significant relationship between budget and available time and resources. This emphasizes the significance of practical factors like budget and available resources in shaping entrepreneurial risk-taking (Adu, Boakye, and Suleman, 2020). The data above shows that there is no significant relationship between responsiveness to opportunities and entrepreneurial ventures in terms of scalability passion and interest. There is a significant relationship between budget, market size and demand, and available time and resources. These insights underscore the importance of strategic financial management and responsiveness to market opportunities in driving entrepreneurial success (Idris, 2024). The data above showed that there is no significant relationship between leadership and entrepreneurial ventures in terms of scalability, market size and demand, and passion and interest. While there is a significant relationship between budget and available time and resources. This emphasizes the significance of practical factors like budget and available resources in developing effective leadership skills in entrepreneurship (Khoury and Elmuti, 2012). The data above showed that there is no significant relationship between intellectual property rights and entrepreneurial ventures in terms of market size and demand passion and interest. There is a significant relationship between scalability, budget, and available time and resources. This emphasizes the significance of practical considerations like budget and available resources in protecting intellectual property for entrepreneurial success (Hall and Zenger, 2020).

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that BSBA students demonstrate strong innovative potential, particularly in creativity, risk-taking, and leadership—key qualities that position them well for entrepreneurial success. However, their ability to recognize and respond effectively to market opportunities remains an area for further growth. The students also exhibit high entrepreneurial intent, especially in terms of scalability and financial planning, but still encounter challenges in assessing market size and engaging customers, underscoring the need for deeper practical business exposure and real-world learning experiences. Moreover, the strong correlation found between

innovation perception and entrepreneurial ventures highlights the critical importance of nurturing creativity, leadership, and risk-taking within the curriculum. Strengthening these capabilities will not only enhance students' confidence but also significantly improve their readiness and success in future entrepreneurial pursuits.

RECOMMENDATIONS

In light of the study's findings and conclusions, it is recommended that the Small Business Development Corporation utilize the data gathered to craft targeted policies and programs that strengthen entrepreneurial innovation in Butuan City, particularly by supporting initiatives that enhance opportunity recognition and market responsiveness. For BSBA students, the study suggests the need for greater exposure to real-world business environments, enabling them to address challenges in market assessment and customer engagement while applying innovative strategies more effectively. Finally, future researchers are encouraged to build upon this study by conducting further investigations on innovation and entrepreneurship, thereby deepening academic understanding, enhancing credibility, and expanding career opportunities in this growing field.

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Managerial Practices on Employee Engagement in the Service Industry

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ABSTRACT

Managerial practices on Employee Engagement understand how the way managers lead, organize, plan, and control their teams influences how engaged employees are within the dynamic service industry by examining this connection the research aims to provide valuable insights for service organizations in the region to cultivate more engaged workforces, ultimately leading to improved performance and a more positive working environment. This study aimed to determine the relationship between managerial practices and employee engagement in the service industry. A descriptive-correlational research design was employed, with Butuan City serving as the research locale. The respondents were regular employees working in salon service industries in Butuan City. A total of 100 employees were surveyed using a purposive sampling technique. A survey questionnaire was used to gather data. Mean, frequency, percentage, and Pearson-r were utilized to analyze the data. The study found that employee engagement in the salon service industry in Butuan City is generally high, with employees demonstrating strong commitment, passion, and motivation. While demographic factors did not significantly influence employee perception of managerial practices or engagement levels, a strong positive relationship was found between effective managerial practices and employee engagement, suggesting that effective leadership and management are key drivers of employee engagement in this industry.

Keywords: *commitment, controlling, employee engagement, involvement, leading, managerial practices, motivation, organizing, passion, planning, service industry, descriptive-correlational design, Philippines*

INTRODUCTION

Managerial practices on employee engagement in the service industry are crucial for organizations to foster a positive work environment and achieve sustainable success (Al-Tamimi & Al-Tamimi, 2021). Engaged employees are more likely to exhibit higher levels of productivity, job satisfaction, and customer loyalty. By identifying effective managerial practices that promote employee engagement, organizations can create a competitive advantage and improve overall performance.

Labor laws and regulations provide the legal framework for fostering a positive and fair work environment. The Labor Code of the Philippines, specifically Article 82, mandates employers to provide a safe, healthful, and conducive working environment for their employees (Republic of the Philippines, 1974). Additionally, the Civil Service Commission (CSC) Memorandum Circular No. 2020-03 provides a comprehensive framework for promoting employee engagement in the Philippine government service (Civil Service Commission, 2020). These circular outlines various strategies and initiatives aimed at enhancing employee morale, job satisfaction, and overall well-being. By adhering to the guidelines outlined in this memorandum, organizations can create a more positive and productive work environment for their employees. Ho and Chiu (2020) while studies have explored managerial practices and employee engagement in various regions, there is a dearth of research that directly compares these factors across multiple cultures.

This gap limits our understanding of how cultural nuances influence the relationship between managerial practices and employee engagement. Ng and Feldman (2021) the global landscape is rapidly evolving, with technological advancements, economic fluctuations, and societal changes impacting both managerial practices and employee expectations. Existing studies may not fully capture the nuances of these emerging trends, leading to a limited understanding of their implications for employee engagement. While previous studies have examined employee engagement in the Philippines, there is a need for more in-depth research that explores the influence of indigenous cultural factors on managerial practices and employee engagement. Understanding these cultural nuances can provide valuable insights into the unique dynamics of the Philippine workplace. Studies have examined employee engagement in major Philippine cities, but there is a lack of research specifically focused on regions like Butuan City. This gap limits our understanding of how regional factors, such as economic conditions, industry characteristics, and local cultural norms, influence managerial practices and employee engagement in different parts of the Philippines.

This managerial practices on employee engagement in the service industry are crucial for business administration students majoring in marketing to gain a comprehensive understanding of the factors that influence employee behavior and organizational performance. By exploring the relationship between managerial practices and employee engagement, students can develop valuable insights into how effective leadership can enhance employee satisfaction, productivity, and customer service. This knowledge will equip them with the skills to implement strategies that foster a positive work environment and contribute to the success of organizations in the service industry. Moreover,

understanding the legal basis for employee engagement in the Philippines will provide students with a strong foundation for navigating the complexities of labor laws and regulations, ensuring compliance, and promoting ethical business practices.

FRAMEWORK

This study was anchored on the Social Exchange Theory (SET) (Homans, 1958). Social Exchange Theory posits that individuals engage in social interactions based on the perceived costs and benefits involved. It suggests that people are motivated to maximize their rewards and minimize their costs in their relationships with others (Homans, 1958). In the context of employee-employer relationships, SET suggests that employees evaluate the rewards they receive from their jobs, such as salary, benefits, and recognition, against the costs they incur, such as workload, stress, and negative interactions with colleagues. When the perceived rewards outweigh the costs, employees are more likely to be engaged and committed to their work (Cropanzano & Mitchell, 2005).

SET is directly relevant to this study because it provides a framework for understanding the factors that influence employee engagement in the service industry.

By examining the perceived rewards and costs associated with employment, SET can help to explain why some employees are more engaged than others. Additionally, SET highlights the importance of social interactions and relationships in the workplace, which can significantly impact employee engagement and satisfaction (Cropanzano & Mitchell, 2005).

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

The study aimed to determine the following objectives: (1) to determine the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of age, sex, educational attainment, year experience, and job position; (2) to assess the respondents' level of perception of managerial practices in terms of planning, organizing, leading, and controlling; (3) to investigate the extent of employee engagement in terms of commitment, passion, involvement, motivation, and alignment; (4) to determine the level of perception of managerial practices and the extent of employee engagement

METHODOLOGY

This study used a descriptive-correlational research design and was conducted at diverse range of salon service businesses in Butuan City, Philippines. The respondents of the study were one hundred regular employees working in salon service industries in Butuan City. This study used a modified survey questionnaire. *Mean, frequency, percentage, and Pearson-r* were utilized to analyze the data.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Problem 1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of age, sex, educational attainment, year experience, and job position?

Age	Frequency	Percentage
20-25	10	10%
25 above	90	90%
Total	100	100%
Sex	Frequency	Percentage
Male	38	38%
Female	62	62%
Total	100	100%
Educational Attainment	Frequency	Percentage
Undergraduate	26	26%
High School Graduate	52	52%
SHS Graduate	10	10%
Graduate	12	12%
Total	100	100%
Year Experience	Frequency	Percentage
1-3 years	27	27%
4-6 years	40	40%
6-8 years	18	18%
7-9 years	5	5%
10 up	10	10%
Total	100	100%
Job position	Frequency	Percentage
Front Desk Staff	24	24%
Hair Stylists	51	51%
Nail Technicians	25	25%
Total	100	100%

The demographic profile of the respondents in terms of age. The majority of the respondents were aged 25 and above (90%). Conversely, only 10% of the respondents were aged between 20 and 25.

The demographic profile of the respondents in terms of sex. The majority of the respondents (62%) were female, indicating a female-dominated workforce in the service industry in Butuan City. Conversely, only 38% of the respondents were male.

The demographic profile of the respondents in terms of educational attainment. The majority of respondents, 52%, are high school graduates, followed by 26% who are undergraduates, 12% who are graduates, and 10% who are SHS graduates. The high percentage of high school graduates in the sample suggests a moderate level of education among salon service workers in Butuan City. This means that while the industry is accessible to those with a high school diploma, salon owners should prioritize practical training programs and encourage further education for career advancement.

The demographic profile of the respondents in terms of year experience. The majority of respondents (40%) have 4-6 years of experience, indicating a significant portion of the workforce has moderate experience in the industry. On the other hand, a smaller proportion of respondents have 7-9 years of experience (10%). This suggests that there may be a lack of experienced professionals in the industry, which could impact the overall quality of service and knowledge transfer.

The demographic profile of the respondents in terms of job position. The majority of the respondents (51%) were "Hair Stylists", indicating that this is the most common job position among the respondents. However, a smaller proportion of respondents were Front Desk Staff (24%). This suggests that the sample may not be fully representative of the entire workforce in the salon service industry, as it may be skewed towards hair stylists.

Problem 2. What is the respondents' level of perception of managerial practices in terms of planning, organizing, leading, and controlling?

Table 12

Summary table on the level of perception of Managerial Practices

Variable	Mean	Verbal Description
Planning	4.57	Strongly Agree
Leading	4.45	Strongly Agree
Organizing	4.42	Strongly Agree
Controlling	4.38	Strongly Agree
Over-all Mean	4.46	Strongly Agree

Legend: 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree; 3.41- 4.20 Agree; 2.61-3.40 Neutral; 1.81-2.60 Strongly Disagree; 1.0-1.80 Disagree

Table 12 illustrated the mean scores, verbal description, and verbal interpretation for four indicators of managerial practices: planning, organizing, leading, and controlling.

This indicator "Planning" received a mean score of 4.57 indicating that employees strongly agree that their managers are effective in planning with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This implies that employees feel their managers are proficient in setting goals, developing comprehensive plans, and involving employees in the planning process.

This indicator "Leading" received a mean score of 4.45 indicating that employees strongly agree that their managers are effective in leading with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This implies that employees perceive their managers as being effective in inspiring them to perform at their best, managing challenges, and providing individualized attention.

This indicator "Organizing" received a mean score of 4.42 indicating that employees strongly agree that their managers are effective in organizing with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This implies that employees feel their managers are effective in establishing clear lines of responsibility, delegating tasks, and creating a well-defined organizational structure.

This indicator "Controlling" received a mean score of 4.38 indicating that employees strongly agree that their managers are effective in controlling with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement ". This indicates that employees feel accountable and supported in their performance, contributing to a culture of continuous improvement.

The overall average of all indicators is 4.46, which falls under the "Strongly Agree" category. This implies that employees in the salon service industry in Butuan City have a positive perception of their managers' practices across all four areas, indicating a strong foundation for a positive and productive work environment. According to Armstrong and Taylor (2020).

Problem 3. What is the extent of employee engagement in terms of commitment, passion, alignment, motivation, and involvement?

Table 18
Summary Table on the extent of employee engagement

Variable	Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
Commitment	4.55	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.
Passion	4.53	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.
Alignment	4.50	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.
Motivation	4.47	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.
Involvement	4.50	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.

Over-all Mean	4.41	Strongly Agree	The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement.
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Legend: 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree; 3.41- 4.20 Agree; 2.61-3.40 Neutral; 1.81-2.60 Strongly Disagree; 1.0-1.80 Disagree

Table 18 illustrated the mean scores, verbal description, and verbal interpretation for five indicators of employee engagement: commitment, passion, involvement, motivation, and alignment.

This indicator "Involvement" has a mean score of 4.41 indicating that employees strongly agree that they are involved in their work with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This suggests that employees feel a sense of ownership and responsibility for their work, leading to increased engagement and productivity.

This indicator "Commitment" received a mean score of 4.55 indicating that employees strongly agree that they are committed to their organization with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement ". This implies that employees feel a strong sense of belonging and dedication to their workplace.

This indicator "Passion" received a mean score of 4.53 indicating that employees strongly agree that they are passionate about their work with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This implies that employees find their work fulfilling and meaningful, contributing to their overall job satisfaction.

This indicator "Motivation" has a mean score of 4.47 indicating that employees strongly agree that they are motivated in their work with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement ". This implies that employees are driven by a variety of factors, such as a sense of accomplishment, the opportunity to grow, and the chance to make a difference.

This indicator an "Alignment" with a mean score of 4.50 indicating that employees strongly agree that they are aligned with the company's values and goals with a verbal interpretation, "The respondent fully and completely agrees with the statement". This implies that employees feel a sense of purpose and belonging within the organization, contributing to a strong organizational culture.

The overall average of all indicators is 4.49, which falls under the "Strongly Agree" category. This implies that employees in the salon service industry in Butuan City have a high level of engagement with their organization, demonstrating strong commitment, passion, involvement, motivation, and alignment. This positive engagement level is crucial for a thriving workplace.

Problem 4. Is there a significant relationship between respondents?**Correlation Analysis between level of perception of managerial practices and the extent of employee engagement**

Indicators		Commitment	Passion	Involvement	Motivation	Alignment
Planning	Correlation Coefficient	0.328	0.512	0.347	0.356	0.328
	P-Value	0.005	<0.001	0.004	0.002	0.005
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Organizing	Correlation Coefficient	0.469	0.382	0.463	0.301	0.336
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	0.006
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Leading	Correlation Coefficient	0.458	0.529	0.331	0.370	0.380
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	0.007	<0.001	<0.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Controlling	Correlation Coefficient	0.394	0.384	0.306	0.223	0.276
	P-Value	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	0.025	0.005
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant

The relationship between planning and employee engagement showed an r-value of “Commitment” (0.328), “Passion” (0.512), “Involvement” (0.347), “Motivation” (0.356), “Alignment” (0.328), indicating low positive correlation that higher level of perception on planning has the higher level of employee engagement. The computed *p*-values of 0.005, 0.001, 0.004, 0.002, and 0.005 for commitment, passion, involvement, motivation, and alignment respectively are less than 0.05, statistically, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. So, there is a significant relationship between planning and employee engagement. How leadership development programs can enhance employee engagement was examined by Donovan and Williams (2023), discussing the benefits of such programs in increasing engagement and developing leadership skills.

The relationship between organizing and employee engagement showed an r-value of “Commitment” (0.469), “Passion” (0.382), “Involvement” (0.463), “Motivation” (0.301), “Alignment” (0.336), indicating low positive correlation, managers with higher organizing tend to have a higher level of employee engagement. The computed *p*-values of commitment, passion, involvement, and motivation are <0.001 , while for alignment *p*-value is 0.006. Based on these results, the computed *p*-value is less than 0.05, statistically, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. So, there is a significant relationship between organizing and the extent of employee engagement. Ellis and Daniels (2019) investigated how managerial support influences employee engagement in the service industry, emphasizing the importance of managerial backing in enhancing employee engagement.

The relationship between leading and employee engagement showed an r-value of “Commitment” (0.458), “Passion” (0.529), “Involvement” (0.331), “Motivation” (0.370), “Alignment” (0.380), indicating low positive correlation, managers with higher leadership tend to have a higher level of employee engagement. The computed *p*-values of commitment, passion, motivation, and alignment are <0.001 , while for involvement *p*-value is 0.007. Based on these results, the computed *p*-value is less than 0.05, statistically, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. So, there is a significant relationship between leading and employee engagement. Brown and Woolley (2021) investigated the role of leadership and management in driving employee engagement within the financial services sector. It emphasizes the importance of leadership practices in enhancing employee engagement and satisfaction.

The relationship between controlling and employee engagement showed an r-value of “Commitment” (0.394), “Passion” (0.384), “Involvement” (0.306), “Motivation” (0.223), “Alignment” (0.276), indicating low positive correlation, managers with higher controlling tend to have a higher level of employee engagement. The computed *p*-values of <0.001 , <0.001 , <0.001 , 0.025, and 0.005 are less than 0.05, statistically, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. So, there is a significant relationship between controlling and employee engagement. Hemmings and Thompson (2020) investigated managerial practices that influence employee well-being and engagement in the service sector. It discusses various practices that can enhance both employee well-being and engagement.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that the salon service industry workforce in Butuan City is predominantly young, female, and moderately educated, with most employees working as hair stylists—indicating the need for specialized training, inclusive environments, and clear pathways for professional growth. While managers are viewed as moderately effective in core managerial functions, strengthening communication, delegation, and feedback practices is essential for improving overall leadership effectiveness.

Employees show strong commitment, passion, and motivation, which salon owners can maximize by providing meaningful opportunities for recognition, advancement, and skill development. Although employee involvement in decision-making is moderate, increasing participation can foster greater ownership and responsibility. The high alignment between employees and organizational values reflects a positive workplace culture that should be continuously reinforced.

Furthermore, the lack of significant influence of demographic factors on perceptions of managerial practices and employee engagement suggests that effective leadership and a supportive environment benefit all employees universally. Finally, the positive impact of strong managerial practices on employee engagement underscores the importance of investing in leadership development to cultivate a productive, motivated, and engaged workforce.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the conclusions of the study, it is recommended that the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) strengthen its role in promoting training and development programs for managers, with a particular focus on improving their competencies in planning, organizing, leading, and controlling. Enhancing these managerial skills will help create more positive and productive work environments across the service industry. DOLE should also consider reviewing and updating labor policies to better address the unique needs of service-sector employees, especially in relation to communication, feedback, and participation in decision-making. Additionally, DOLE is encouraged to advocate for initiatives that support workplace wellness, including programs that promote work-life balance, stress management, and overall employee well-being. For salon owners, improving employee engagement should involve increasing employee participation in operational decision-making, investing in leadership training for managers, establishing clear communication and feedback systems, and implementing recognition programs that reward employee contributions.

The PECIT administration can likewise foster a more efficient and positive workplace by enhancing managerial capacity through targeted training, encouraging employee involvement in crafting policies and operational improvements, and cultivating a culture of open communication and appreciation. Students can use the findings of this

study to better understand how research applies to real workplace issues, particularly the role of effective management in shaping employee engagement. Finally, future researchers are encouraged to explore additional influences on employee engagement, assess the applicability of these findings in other industries or locations, and examine the long-term impacts of strong managerial practices on both engagement and organizational performance..

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The Architect of Choice: Personal Factors Guiding Senior High School Strand Preferences

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ABSTRACT

The transition from junior high to senior high school marks a pivotal juncture in students' academic journey, presenting them with a crucial decision regarding their chosen strand specialization. This descriptive-correlational study investigated the factors influencing senior high school students' strand preferences in the Philippines. A survey (n=110) of Grade 11 students at Libertad National High School revealed personal interest as the most decisive influence, followed by parental support, autonomy, and career aspirations. These findings call for a deeper understanding from the faculty, as they highlight the need for personalized learning. The high participation rate indicates strong student interest in their educational paths, which the faculty can use as a basis for developing programs that cater to student needs and preferences. While students value open communication with parents and appreciate their support, they also prefer autonomy in decision-making. Peers provide a platform for discussion but have minimal influence. The identified gap between student needs and the curriculum highlights the potential benefits of incorporating personalized learning models, a task the faculty can take on to serve the students better.

KEYWORDS

Senior high school strands, student preferences, descriptive-correlational, parental influence, career guidance, personalized learning, Mean, Pearson-r, Frequency and Percentage, Philippines

INTRODUCTION

Job mismatch occurs when workers' skills and qualifications do not match their job requirements. This can happen in several ways, such as when workers are over- or under-

educated or need more skills and experience to perform their jobs effectively. In addition, job mismatches can negatively affect both workers and employers.

The transition from junior high to senior high school marks a pivotal juncture in students' academic journey, presenting them with a crucial decision regarding their chosen strand specialization. Rafanan & De Guzman (2020) argue that understanding the factors influencing strand preferences among senior high school students is paramount for guiding them toward informed decisions that align with their interests, aptitudes, and future goals. Additionally, Podolsky et al. (2019) found that policymakers can develop policies that incentivize schools to offer high-demand programs.

In the Philippine context, job mismatches have become commonplace occurrences despite being an alarming problem in the labor market as a result of the growing number of job applicants wanting to start and advance in their professions. According to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (PIDS), 40% of Filipino workers possess academic credentials above and beyond those required for their positions. Yet, these workers only received a 5% pay raise for completing their degrees. According to the leading online job portal Job Street, a job mismatch is a growing phenomenon wherein the skills required to be successful in a particular position and the skills possessed by a specific employee are not entirely aligned with each other, consequently affecting the employee's work productivity, motivation, and development (Philippine Institute for Development Studies, 2022).

Job mismatch is a prevalent issue in the CARAGA Region of the Philippines. According to a 2022 report by the Regional Development Council (RDC), 60% of employed individuals in the region are underemployed, meaning they are working in jobs that do not match their skills or qualifications. This is due to several factors, including a lack of job opportunities in high-demand fields, a mismatch between the workforce's skills and employers' needs, and a need for more access to quality education and training.

In the local context, a study made by Autentico and Alerta (2020) in the SY. 2018 - 2019, it was discovered that there was a high incidence of employment mismatch among the first employed batches of TVL graduates in Butuan City, Philippines. The study reveals that 64% (171) mismatch incidence. Furthermore, the logistic regression analysis results demonstrate that job mismatch occurrence is significantly influenced by characteristics such as national certification, faculty and teaching, work experience, workers' compensation, and family assistance. The study's findings show an apparent mismatch between competence and employment.

With the abovementioned situation, this study is intended to deal with the growing problem of choosing a strand in senior high school. Whatever the outcome of this study is, it will serve as the foundation for the researcher to design a recommendation that will aid in solving this strand preferences problem in school. By studying strand preferences, researchers can gain insights into the factors most important to students when making this decision. Furthermore, this information can be used to develop resources and programs to help students make more informed choices. Moreover, to identify and address barriers to student success.

FRAMEWORK

This study was anchored on the Vocational Personality Types Theory (Holland et al., 1960). The vocational personality types theory, also known as Holland's theory, suggests that people are more likely to be satisfied with their careers if they choose a job compatible with their personality type. This theory posits that there are six personality types: First, Realistic. Realistic people prefer to work with their hands and with concrete objects. They are often skilled in mechanical and physical tasks. Second, Investigative. Investigative people are curious and analytical. They enjoy solving problems and conducting research. Third, artistic. Artistic people are creative and imaginative. They enjoy expressing themselves through art, music, and writing. Fourth, social. Social people are outgoing and people-oriented. They enjoy helping others and working in teams. Fifth, enterprising. Enterprising people are ambitious and persuasive. They enjoy taking on challenges and leading others. Last, conventional. Conventional people are organized and detail-oriented. They enjoy following rules and procedures. However, the theory is the most specific and well-established theory of vocational personality types, and it has been widely used to predict student's career and educational choices.

The vocational personality types theory is related to the study "Strand preferences among Senior high school students" because both are concerned with the relationship between personality type and career choice. At the same time, the vocational personality types theory suggests that people are more likely to be satisfied with their careers if they choose a job compatible with their personality type. The study entitled "Strand Preferences among Senior High School Students" investigates the factors that influence grade 11 students' preferences for different academic strands, and personality type is one of the factors considered.

Overall, the vocational personality types theory suggests that people are more likely to be successful and satisfied in careers compatible with their personality type. The study "Strand Preferences among Senior High School Students" is crucial because it can help students make informed decisions about their academic choices. By understanding their personality type and the relationship between personality type and strand preferences, students can choose a strand that is likely to fit them. This can help them to be more successful and satisfied in their future careers.

Figure 1. shows the framework of the study. The concept behind the study framework is entitled "Strand Preferences among Senior High School Students." The study's framework is based on the idea that various factors influence strand preferences among senior high school students. These factors can be broadly categorized into three groups: First is in independent variables. These are the factors that are thought to influence the dependent variables. This study's independent variables are age, sex, and parents' occupations. The second is dependent variables. These are the factors that are influenced by the independent variables. This study's dependent variables are the predictors of strand preferences: parental, peer, personal, socioeconomic status, job opportunities, and academic competence. The third is on output variables. These are the outcomes of the study. In this study, the output variable is the intervention program.

The concept behind the framework is that by understanding the factors that influence strand preferences, researchers can develop interventions to help students

make more informed decisions about their academic future. The study proposes that an intervention program that addresses the predictors of strand preferences can help students better understand their interests and strengths, learn about the different strands and their requirements, consider their career goals and aspirations, and make informed decisions about their strand preferences.

The study also proposes that the intervention program should be tailored to the specific needs of the students. The program should consider the student's age, sex, and parents' occupations. The study's framework has several potential benefits. First, it can help to improve student outcomes by enabling students to make more informed decisions about their academic future. Second, it can help reduce educational inequality by providing all students with the information and support they need to make successful educational decisions. Third, it can improve the efficiency of the education system by helping students to choose the right strand for their interests and abilities.

The study's framework also has some limitations. First, it is based on the assumption that the factors identified in the study are the most critical factors influencing strand preferences. Other factors may be just as essential but must be identified in the study. Second, the study's framework assumes that the intervention program will be effective in helping students make informed decisions about their strand preferences. The intervention program may need to be more practical or will only be effective for a specific subset of students.

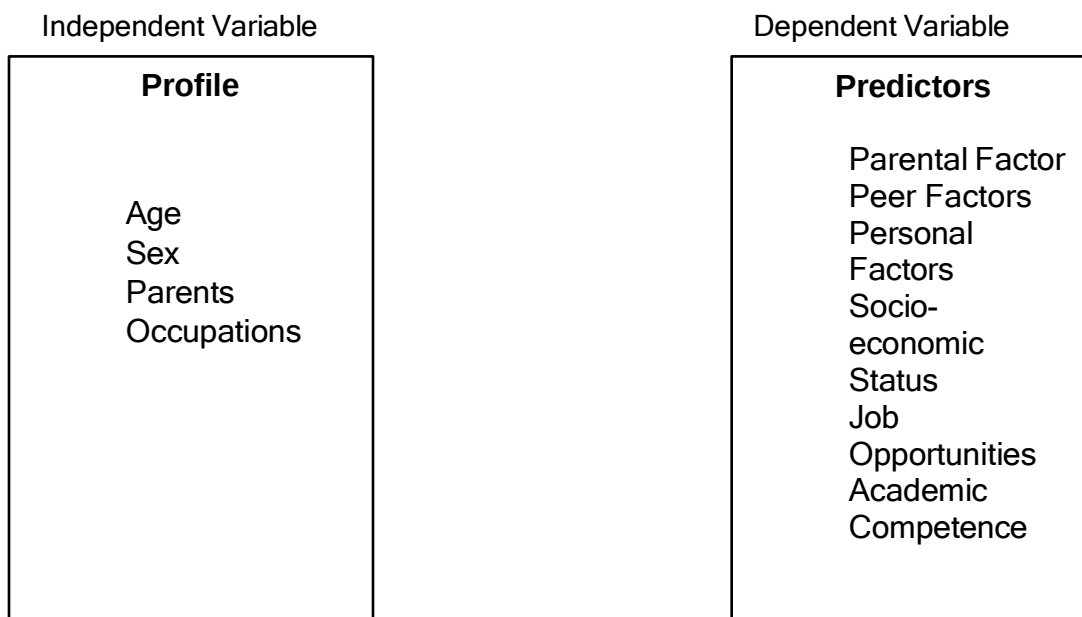


Figure 1. Schematic Diagram of the Study

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study is pursued to determine the following objectives: (1) Identify the strand preferences among Senior high school students in terms of: parental factors, peer factors, personal factors, socio-economic status, job opportunities, and academic competence. (2) Determine the significant relationship between the profile and the strand preferences among Senior High School Students.

METHODOLOGY

The study used a descriptive-correlational research design. The study was conducted at the Libertad National High School. Located at P-6, Balanghai Road, Barangay, Libertad, Butuan City, Agusan Del Norte. The respondents of the study were the Grade 11 Students. 110 Grade 11 students served as respondents, 40 males and 70 females. In this study, researchers utilized convenience sampling, meaning all 110 students with parental consent were included as respondents. This study used an adapted survey tool. The survey questionnaire was adapted from the research entitled "Determinants of influence patterns on the strand preferences of incoming senior high school students of South Butuan District II" by Batula et al. (2023)—the tool aimed to evaluate the predictors of strand preferences among Senior high school students. These were the statistics used in the study: Mean. This statistical tool was used to identify the factors that predict pupils in Grade 11 students strand choices. Pearson-r. This statistical tool was used to determine the significant relationship between the profile of the respondents and the strand preferences. Frequency and Percentage. This statistical tool determined the respondents' profiles based on frequencies and percentages.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Table 1. *Summary Table of Strand Preferences*

Indicators	Overall Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
Parental factor	3.90	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion.
Peer factor	2.86	Slightly Agree	They may agree with some parts of the statement but not others.

Personal factor	4.13	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion.
Socio-economic status	3.60	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion.
Job opportunities	3.84	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion.
Academic competence	4.08	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion.
Grand Mean	3.74	Agree	They may have some minor reservations or doubts about their opinion

Legend: 4.12 – 5.00 (Strongly Agree) 3.41 – 4.20 (Agree) 2.60 – 3.40 (Slightly Agree) 1.81 - 2.60 (Disagree) 1.00 -1.80 (Strongly Disagree)

Table 1 reveals Strand Preferences. With the highest mean score of 4.13, personal factors hold the most substantial sway, suggesting students prioritize their interests and aspirations when selecting a strand. Conversely, peer pressure garnered the lowest average score of 2.86, indicating a weaker influence on their decisions than other factors. However, Students surveyed generally agree with an average score of 3.74 that various factors influence their academic track choices. The data suggests that students make choices based on their goals and aspirations, with personal factors outweighing peer pressure in shaping their academic paths. This aligns with research by Santiago et al. (2023), who found that students prioritize personal interests over peer influence.

Table 2. Correlation analysis Between Respondents Demographic Profile and Strand Preferences

Profile		Parental Factors	Peer Factors	Personal Factors	Socioeconomic Status	Job Opportunities	Academic Competence
Age	Correlation Coefficient	-0.095	0.111	-0.059	-0.029	-0.145	-0.135
	P-value	0.324	0.253	0.547	0.764	0.131	0.163
	Decision	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant
	Correlation Coefficient	-0.099	-0.255	-0.030	-0.049	-0.064	0.124

Sex	P-value	0.303	0.007	0.756	0.611	0.507	0.197	KMRJ
	Decision	Accepted	Rejected	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	
Parents Occupation	Correlation Coefficient	0.087	0.012	0.164	0.080	0.084	0.127	
	P-value	0.366	0.909	0.087	0.061	0.383	0.190	
	Decision	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	Accepted	
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	Not Significant	

Correlation at the level of 0.05 (two-tailed)

Table 2 presents the correlation between profile and strand preferences regarding age. The extreme data includes the highest positive correlation of 0.111 between peers and the lowest correlation of -0.145 with job opportunities. These correlations indicate shallow relationships between the variables. The study accepts the null hypothesis for all correlations due to their low values. Additionally, the study acknowledges the null hypothesis, implying no statistically significant relationship between age and profile preferences. This data aligns with the findings of Lafia et al. (2020) on researchers referencing social science data, emphasizing the importance of understanding the motivations behind data references. The overall conclusion is that age has minimal influence on the preferences for different academic strands among the participants, as indicated by the weak correlations observed in the study.

In terms of the correlation between profile and strand preferences concerning sex, showing very low negative correlations for parental R-value of -0.099 and P-value 0.303, peers R-value -0.255, P-value 0.007, personal R-value -0.030, P-value 0.756, socio-economic R-value -0.049, P-value 0.611, and job opportunities R-value -0.064, P-value 0.507, while academic competence has a very low positive correlation R-value 0.124, P-value 0.197. The data implies that peers significantly influence strand preferences, rejecting the null hypothesis. In contrast, other factors like parental influence, personal preferences, socio-economic status, job opportunities, and academic competence show negligible effects on the preferences. This suggests that social interactions play a more substantial role in shaping students' strand preferences than other factors considered in the study, highlighting the importance of peer influence in educational decision-making. This correlates to the (Xu, 2022) found that the potential dominance of peer influence in shaping strand preferences, particularly for students considering strands that differ from what their peers choose (Xu, 2022).

In terms of the correlations between profile and strand preferences based on parents' occupation in a study. The highest correlation between socio-economic factors and preferences is 0.180, while the lowest is with peers, 0.012. These very low to low positive correlations suggest a weak relationship between parents' occupation profile and students' preferences, indicating that parental occupation does not strongly influence the choice of academic strand. There is no significant relationship between the profile and parents' occupation. Therefore, accept the null hypothesis. The study's conclusion could

highlight the importance of considering a holistic approach to understanding students' academic choices, considering multiple influences beyond parental occupation. It unifies with recent studies highlighting the multifaceted nature of factors influencing students' academic decisions (Wang et al., 2021).

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that students in the institution demonstrate a high level of engagement and enthusiasm toward their education, as reflected in strong participation across various demographics, creating a supportive environment for program development and further research. While students value parental support and open communication, they also seek autonomy in decision-making, and peer influence appears minimal, indicating a balanced approach to guidance and independence. Although students generally believe their chosen strands prepare them for future endeavors, the curriculum may not fully address individual needs, highlighting the importance of personalized learning approaches that align with students' strengths and interests. Implementing flexible models, such as the La Carte system, can better accommodate students' unique learning preferences and career aspirations, while guidance programs play a critical role in helping them explore and navigate specific job opportunities within their fields.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the results and findings of the study, it is recommended that educational institutions strategically guide resource allocation by ensuring each strand is supported with qualified teachers, appropriate facilities, and relevant learning materials that align with student interests and needs. Career guidance programs should be tailored using data on student strand preferences, taking into account both academic strengths and personal interests to provide more targeted advice on future opportunities. Schools are encouraged to integrate experiential activities—such as guest speakers, workplace visits, and career fairs—that allow students to explore potential career paths related to their chosen strands. Parents should actively engage in discussions with their children about their interests and aspirations, providing support to help students make well-informed decisions regarding their academic paths. Students, in turn, are encouraged to reflect on their own strengths, interests, and career goals when selecting strands, while future research should explore additional factors influencing student preferences, such as socio-economic background, peer influence, and parental guidance, to create a more holistic understanding of student decision-making.

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Time Management and Study Habits Among Education Students

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ABSTRACT

For education students, balancing academic responsibilities requires time management effective time management and discipline study habits. The way they structure their schedules, prioritize tasks, and approach learning can significantly impact their academic performance and overall wellbeing. The present study aimed to ascertain the correlation between time management and study habits among education students (n = 98). A descriptive correlational design was used, and a survey questionnaire was employed to measure the participants' study habits and behavior time management. The distribution of academic performance across the year-level sample reflected a promising beginning for education students. However, the study recommended continuing attention to this group of students, especially the underrepresented first-year students. Likewise, the current group of students seemed male-dominant, thus encouraging gender balance in subsequent research. The results show a moderate perception of self-discipline and time awareness among students. Several of the study concerns consist of problems with time scheduling, stress management, and work-life balance. Interestingly, only self-discipline significantly predicts time management and academic performance. The study also examined the expected awareness of the students with good study habits and concluded that students needed to be more consistent in demonstrating good practice. This was evidenced in the areas of organization, such as studying, self-care, and time management, which create a good study environment. This demands a combination of support and a push from the academe, parents, and other concerned individuals in attending various workshops and seminars on goal setting, stress managing, organizing the resources to support the student, and collaboration of the parents and the academe. The study recommended for future researchers should be a comprehensive study on the

effect of self-discipline, stress management, family support, and financial constraints on the students' academic performances.

KEYWORDS

Time Management, Study Habits, Self-discipline, academic success, Philippines.

INTRODUCTION

Time management and study habits are two of the most important factors for success in college. Bachelor of Elementary Education (BEED) students need to be able to manage their time effectively and develop good study habits in order to meet the demands of their program. The Department of education (DepEd) has also issued several orders and memoranda on the importance of time management and study habits for instance, DepEd Order No. 34, 2012, or the Basic Education Learning Competencies in English Mathematics and Science, includes competencies on time management and study habits.

Effective time management and study habits equip students to be productive and accomplish their goals according to set schedules and deadlines (Dawson, 2020). Students who manage their time effectively are more likely to complete their assignments on time, study for exams effectively and earn good grades (Xu, 2022). This is because they can prioritize their tasks, manage their time effectively and stay focused on their studies. Time management is an essential skill for success in all aspects of life, not just academics. Students who learn how to manage their time effectively will be better equipped to succeed in their future careers and personal lives. Students who develop good study habits may find it difficult to detach from their studies and prioritize other aspects of life, such as sleep or socializing (Whinston & Dawson, 2020). A student can be more intelligent and have self-confidence in class compared to those who do not develop their study habits (Tekkol & Demirel, 2018).

National University of Singapore (2020) found that 80% of the students who reported using effective time management strategies had GPA above 3.5, more than those who did not. At the same time the De La Salle University in the Philippines (2022) conducted a study and found out that 60% of the students who had poor time management skills experienced stress, anxiety, and depression. A student who has poor time management skills may find themselves feeling overwhelmed and stressed. They may procrastinate on their schoolwork and fall behind.

In Caraga Region, time management and study habits are also important factors in the academic success of BEED students. Surigao State College of Technology (2023) also conducted research that has shown that poor time management is a risk for mental health problems in students. In the study it is stipulated that students and professionals

in Butuan City have poor time management skills. This is evident from the fact that 55% of respondents reported feeling overwhelmed by their work. Time management and study habits are essential for success in any academic program, but they are especially important for BEED students. BEED students are preparing to become teachers, and they need to be able to manage their time effectively and develop good study habits to be successful in the classroom and beyond.

This research study investigated the time management and study habits of BEED students in PECIT. The findings of this study helped to identify areas where BEED students need additional support and develop interventions to improve their time management and study habits. That ultimately leads to improved academic.

BEED students, which will benefit both personally and professionally. One of the key recommendations of the study is that BEED students should develop a time management plan. This plan should identify their goals, prioritize their tasks, and schedule their time accordingly. Students should also learn to break down tasks into smaller, more manageable ones.

FRAMEWORK

This study is anchored on Social Cognitive Theory by Bandura (1977) and Social Learning Theory by Jean Piaget (1930s).

Social cognitive theory (SCT) is a theory of social learning and behavior change that posits that people learn new behaviors by observing and imitating others, and by receiving reinforcement for their behavior. The theory also emphasizes the importance of personal factors, such as beliefs and attitudes, in influencing behavior.

Emerging from Piaget's work on cognitive stages, his theory suggests college students' potential for abstract reasoning and peer influence could explain their time management strategies and intrinsic motivation to learn. The theory emphasizes cognitive development stages, suggesting college students may be at Formal Operational Stage (abstract thinking, hypothetical-deductive reasoning). This could explain their ability to plan, prioritize and reflect on their time management strategies.

Social learning theory (SLT) is a theory of cognitive development that explains how a child constructs a mental mode of the world. The theory disagrees with the idea that intelligence was a fixed trait and regarded cognitive development as a process that occurs due to biological maturation and interaction with the environment.

SLT acknowledges the influence of peers and social environments on learning and behavior. This could be relevant in understanding how college students learn from and support each other in developing time management and study habits. Piaget also highlights intrinsic motivation driven by curiosity and exploration. This could be linked to students' interest in maximizing learning and personal development, in turn will fuel their efforts to manage time and study effectively.

SCT was developed by Albert Bandura in the 1970s, and it has since become one of the most influential theories in psychology. SCT has been used to explain a wide range

of behaviors, including aggression, anxiety, depression, obesity, and prosocial behavior. SCT is based on the following key principles namely: observational learning, where students can learn new behaviors by observing others; vicarious reinforcement, where students can learn new behaviors by observing the consequences of others' behaviors; self-efficacy, where students' beliefs about their ability to perform a behavior influence their motivation to try the behavior and their expectations of success.

SCT has been used to develop effective interventions for a wide range of problems. For example, SCT has been used to develop programs to reduce aggression, promote self-esteem, and teach people new skills. SCT is a valuable tool for educators who want to help their students learn and grow.

SCT posits that people learn new behaviors by observing and imitating others, and by receiving reinforcement for their behavior. This means that students are likely to learn time management and study habits from their parents, teachers, peers, and the media. For example, students who see their parents managing their time effectively are more likely to do the same themselves. Similarly, students who are taught about time management and study habits in school are more likely to develop good time management and study habits.

SCT also emphasizes the importance of personal factors, such as beliefs and attitudes, in influencing behavior. This means that students' beliefs and attitudes about time management and studying will also influence their time management and study habits. For example, students who believe that time management is important and who have a positive attitude towards studying are more likely to develop good time management and study habits.

Overall, SCT can be used to explain a wide range of factors that influence time management and study habits among college students. By understanding how SCT can be applied to the study of time management and study habits, researchers can develop more effective ways to help college students develop good time management and study habits. By using SCT in their research, researchers can gain a better understanding of the factors that influence time management and study habits among college students. This information can then be used to develop more effective interventions to help college students develop good time management and study habits.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study investigated the relationship between time management and study habits among education students.

Specifically, this study sought to answer the following questions: (1) What is the extent of time management among education students in terms of self-discipline, time awareness, stress management, work-life balance, and social support? (2) What is the extent of study habits among education students in terms of: financial constraints; health and well-being procrastination; and study environment? (3) Is there a significant

relationship between the extent of time management, education students and study habits?

METHODOLOGY

This study used a descriptive-correlational research design. This study was conducted in Philippine Electronics and Communication Institute of Technology. The respondents of this study were the education students of the Philippine Electronics and Communication Institute of Technology. Mean. This statistical tool was used to determine the extent of time management among BEED students. To determine the extent of study habits among BEED students. Pearson-r. This statistical tool was used to determine the relationship between time management and study habits among Bachelor of Elementary Education students. Frequency and Percentage. This statistical tool was used to determine the demographic profile of the respondents.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Table. 1. Summary table of the extent of Study Habits

Indicators	Overall Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
Study Environment	4.05	Often	Students may have some minor reasons for disagreeing, or they may simply not be convinced of the statement's truth.
Financial Constraints	3.88	Often	Students may have some minor reasons for disagreeing, or they may simply not be convinced of the statement's truth.
Health and Well- Being	3.81	Often	Students may have some minor reasons for disagreeing, or they may simply not be convinced of the statement's truth.
Procrastination	3.77	Often	Students may have some minor reasons for disagreeing, or they may simply not be convinced of the statement's truth.
Academic Performance	3.71	Often	Students may have some minor reasons for disagreeing, or they may simply not be convinced of the statement's truth.
Grand Mean	3.84		

Legend 5 (4.21-5.00) Always 4 (3.41-4.20) Often 3 (2.61-3.40) Sometimes 2 (1.81-2.60) Seldom 1 (1.00-1.80) Never

Table 1 presents the summary of the extent of study habits, In the presented indicators, the study environment emerges with the highest mean score of 4.5, suggesting strong confidence in the quality of study spaces. Conversely, procrastination has the lowest score of 3.77, indicating challenges in managing procrastination tendencies. This suggests that students acknowledge procrastination as an issue but may underestimate its prevalence in their study habits (Dawson, 2020). While procrastination presented notable obstacles, respondents demonstrated confidence in managing financial constraints, maintaining health and well-being, and benefiting from effective study environments.

Table. 2. Correlation Between Variables of Study Habits and Time management of the Study

Study Habits	Time Management	r Value	P Value	Remarks	Decision	Conclusion
Financial Constraints	Self-Discipline	0.045	0.660	Moderate positive correlation	Accepted	Not Significant
	Time Awareness	0.620	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Stress Management	0.564	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Work-Life Balance	0.620	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Social Support	0.383	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
Health and Well-Being	Self-Discipline	0.5	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Time Awareness	0.511	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Stress Management	0.634	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Work-Life Balance	0.664	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant

	Social Support	0.543	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
Procrastination	Self-Discipline	0.427	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Time Awareness	0.502	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Stress Management	0.534	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Work-Life Balance	0.550	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Social Support	0.324	0.000	Very low negative correlation	Rejected	Significant
Study Environment	Self-Discipline	0.542	0.001	Very low positive correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Time Awareness	0.394	0.000	Very low positive correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Stress Management	0.410	0.000	Very low positive correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Work-Life Balance	0.480	0.000	Very low positive correlation	Rejected	Significant
	Social Support	0.227	0.025	Very low positive correlation	Rejected	Significant

*Correlation at the level of 0.05 (Two-tailed)

Table 2 presents the test of correlation between study habits and time management of the study. On study habits, where time management has a weak positive correlation ($r=0.045$, $p=0.660$) with financial constraints, the correlation is not statistically significant. For the other factors (time awareness, stress management, work-life balance, social support), there were very weak negative correlations (around 0.6) that were statistically significant ($p=0.000$) but likely not meaningful in real-world terms. (Xu, 2023). The table suggested a study on health and well-being, where self-discipline, time awareness, stress management, work-life balance, and social support all have very weak

negative correlations (around 0.5-0.6) with health and well-being, despite being statistically significant ($p=0.000$). These correlations are likely not meaningful in real-world terms (Chen, 2022). The table showed a study on procrastination, where self-discipline, time awareness, stress management, work-life balance and social support all have very weak negative correlations (around 0.4-0.5) with procrastination despite being statistically significant ($p=0.000$). These correlations are likely not meaningful in real-world terms (Lee, 2023). The table explored a study environment. While self-discipline, time awareness, stress management, and work-life balance show statistically significant positive correlations ($p\text{-values} < .005$) with a study environment, the r values (around 0.2-0.5) suggest these relationships are weak and may not be impactful in practice (Singh, 2021). Social support has a very weak positive correlations ($r=0.227$) that is marginally significant ($p=0.025$), requiring further investigation.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the following conclusions are given: Struggles with consistent scheduling, stress management, and work-life balance, highlighting the need for broader time management interventions. Self-discipline emerges as the strongest predictor of time management, but stress management, social support, and other factors require a comprehensive understanding of this complex issue. The awareness-action gap in applying good study habits necessitates interventions and holistic educator support to address the complex challenges students face. Though self-discipline is the strongest predictor of academic success, a holistic approach is necessary due to the complex interplay with factors like financial constraints, time awareness, social support, and work-life balance. Beyond study habits, a holistic approach that bridges the awareness-action gap and tackles financial pressures, self-discipline development, and healthy study environments is crucial for academic success, with further research needed to refine this comprehensive support system.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the result and findings of the study, the following recommendations are forwarded:

School Administrators. Develop a multifaceted students support system that has study areas. This could involve incorporating workshops on goal setting, stress management, and organization.

Parents. Communicate with teachers. Stay informed about your child's academic progress and work collaboratively with teachers to address any challenges. College Students. Develop self-discipline. Set clear goals, create a study schedule, and find ways to hold yourself accountable. Utilize resources like academic advisors or tutors for extra help.

Future Researchers. Explore the connections between self-discipline, time awareness, stress management, social support, and financial constraints to understand how they influence academic success.

Office of Student Affairs and Services (OSAS). Offer workshops on stress management and healthy coping mechanisms to bridge the gap between awareness and action, promoting well-being alongside effective study habits. Guidance. Develop programs utilizing the study's findings to address mental health concerns. Equip students with stress management techniques and healthy coping mechanisms to navigate academic pressures effectively.

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Coping Mechanism On Cohabitation Among College Students

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ABSTRACT

The increasing acceptance of non-traditional relationships and the evolving social landscape have led to a rise in cohabitation among college students, necessitating a deeper understanding of their experiences, challenges, and coping strategies. This study employed a phenomenological design and snowball sampling technique to explore the social perspective on cohabitation among college students. Ten participants from the College of Teachers Education in PECIT were interviewed, and data was analyzed using thematic analysis and coding. The study found that young people face pressures, judgments, and expectations that shape their sexual preferences and decisions. They often lack comprehensive information about reproductive health and may not feel comfortable discussing sex openly. This highlights the need for sexuality education, emphasizing responsibility, consequences, communication, and empowerment in sexual decision-making. This research has implications for youth programs, awareness campaigns, parental guidance, and future research. The findings of this research go beyond just affecting learners' lives within schools but will also influence parents' communities, even some government departments, including DSWD, DOH other researchers in the future years ahead. These recommendations bring up questions regarding the involvement played by each stakeholder towards facilitating transformation, starting from developing youth programmers to creating awareness campaigns focused on accuracy.

KEYWORDS

exploring, social, perspective, cohabitation, college students, thematic analysis, coding, Philippines.

INTRODUCTION

Fornication is the sexual activity that takes place between two people who are not married to each other. It is a common practice in many cultures worldwide, but its prevalence varies from population to population. Premarital sexual behavior is influenced by a variety of circumstances, according to several research. Peer pressure, familial background, socioeconomic level, religiousness, age, exposure to pornographic materials/mass media, internet exposure, and drug misuse are only a few of these influences (Gregersen, 2022). Republic Act No. 9208 is an act to institute policies to eliminate trafficking in persons, especially women and children, establishing the necessary institutional mechanisms for the penalties for its violations and others. In DepEd Order No. 31, s. 2018, the Department of Education (DepEd) issued the enclosed Policy Guidelines on the Implementation of Comprehensive Sexuality Education (CSE), which aims to establish a common understanding of CSE key concepts and messages and to ensure transparent implementation of protocols in the CSE—conducted the study to determine Prevalence of pre-marital sex and associated factors among health science students of Madawalabu University, Ethiopia. However, (Yau et al., 2020) The authors stand that studying pre-marital sex could be an effective way to increase adolescents' knowledge, attitudes, and perceptions of risk and protective behaviors to enable them to make healthy decisions. (Biratu, Garoma, Getachew, & Desalegn 2022) Therefore, school and community-based sexual health education and communication need to be intensified to reduce premarital sex and further health consequences. College student cohabitation is becoming increasingly common, yet social perceptions remain varied. This phenomenological study seeks to understand the subjective experiences of college students who cohabit, exploring the social meanings they attach to this living arrangement.

FRAMEWORK

This study was anchored on the Sexual Scripts Theory (Gagnon, 1973), a sociological theory that proposes that culturally learned scripts guide human sexual behavior. These scripts provide individuals with a framework for understanding and interpreting sexual situations, and they influence their thoughts, feelings, and behaviors during sexual interactions. Sexual scripts are not innate or biological but rather are learned through socialization. They identified several factors that contribute to the development of sexual scripts, including Firstly, Media. Movies, television shows, music, and other forms of media often portray idealized images of sexuality that can shape individuals' expectations about how sexual interactions should occur—secondly, Peer groups. Individuals learn about sexuality from their friends and peers, and they may adopt the sexual scripts that are prevalent in their social circles. Lastly, Family. Parents and other family members can also influence individuals' sexual scripts, either through explicit instruction or implicit messages about sexuality.

Sexual scripts theory can be an appropriate framework for studying the lived experiences of students engaging in sexual intercourse, as it can help to shed light on the

cultural, social, and psychological factors that influence their sexual behavior. Sexual scripts provide a framework for understanding sexual behavior: Sexual scripts offer individuals a set of expectations and norms about how sexual interactions should occur. This can be helpful for students, as it can give them a sense of structure and predictability when navigating sexual situations. However, it can also be limiting, as it can restrict individuals' options and make them feel they must conform to certain expectations. Sexual scripts are influenced by a variety of factors: Sexual scripts are not created in a vacuum. They are influenced by various factors, including media, peer groups, family, and personal experiences. Sexual scripts can have a significant impact on sexual health: The way that students understand and interpret sexual scripts can have a substantial effect on their sexual health.

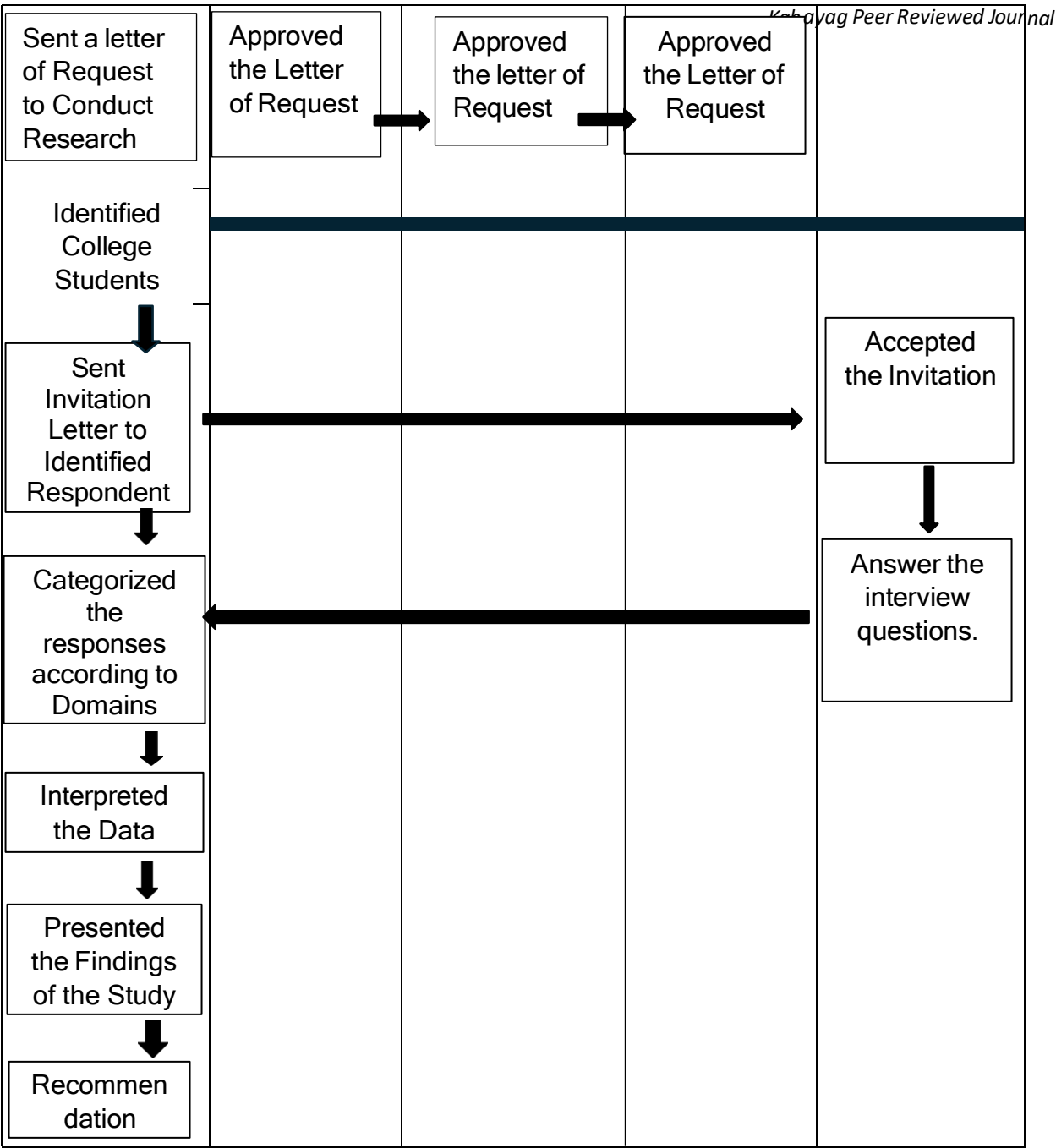


Figure 1. Research Flow

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study aimed to identify the coping strategies employed by college students at PECIT to address challenges encountered during cohabitation.

METHODOLOGY

This study employed a phenomenological design and snowball sampling technique to explore the social perspective on cohabitation among college students. Ten participants from the College of Teachers Education in PECIT were interviewed, and data were analyzed using thematic analysis and coding.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Table 1. *Coping Mechanisms of College Students*

THEME	SUB-THEMES	PARTICIPANTS	VERBATIM RESPONSES
Sexual Experiences and Decision-Making	Confidence in Decision	P4	Wala ko na hadlok kay kagustuhan na namo duha.
		P5	Yes, I was informed because hinlo siya na pag ka lalaki. Of course I have a standard choosing the right man.
		P7	So kadto na time nag sabot mi after eight months na mi mag sex so confident ko ato na adlaw na mosugot nako kay nakita nako siya na seryoso siya ug ako ang una niya na oyab.
		P6	Salig ko na maki pag hilawas niya kay kaila man mi ug love sab namo ang usag usa.
		P1	Kuan kanang one hundred percent confident ko nga ihatag na gyud sa iya kay sure naman ko ato nga time ug nag last meg pila ka years adisir ko niya na hilabtan.
		P2	Kabalo ko nga confident ko sa akung decision ky kabalo ko sa akung partner na limpyo sya ky ako syang ge kilatis ug

		KMRJ
		maayu, wala syay sakit or dli sya mang gamit ug lain bae nga naay sakit.
P8		Ahm para sa ako is kampante na kaayu ko ky ako namang nasinati siya.
P9		By analyzing situations and using a material for example pills because I have our I have already daughter naman so I am using pills in order to me to have not another baby.
P3		Kuan about sa mga advices, gusto sila maka sayud kung unsay akung na experience before about sa sex.
P10		Kuan gugmaan man so mao to nahatag ang tanan.

Table 1 responses revealed a focus on sexual experiences and the decision-making processes surrounding them. A common theme is confidence, though the reasons for this confidence vary from personal pleasure to deeply held feelings of love. Some responses draw on personal experiences to inform their decisions, highlighting the potential for learning from past encounters. While the focus on confidence hints at the agency, there is a concerning lack of emphasis on vital aspects of sexual health, like informed consent, protection against unintended pregnancies, and sexually transmitted infections. This suggests that while these individuals may feel empowered in their choices, a more comprehensive understanding of sexual health and healthy relationships is needed.

A recent analysis of discussions surrounding sexual experiences highlights a concerning lack of emphasis on vital aspects of sexual health (Smith, 2023). While individuals express confidence in their decision-making, there is a need for a greater understanding of informed consent, protection, and the importance of healthy relationships. This suggests that while people may feel empowered in their choices, a more comprehensive approach to sexual health education is necessary to promote both confidence and well-being.

Table 2. *Coping Mechanisms of College Students*

THEME	SUB-THEMES	PARTICIPANTS	VERBATIM RESPONSES
Teenage Pregnancy Experiences	Information Sources	P2	Advices from those people who are older than me, and also research and guidance.
		P7	

		Pag hapit na akong ting dugo unya wala pako gi dugo so mag search ko sa google or mangutana ko sa akong friends na mama na.
	P9	Yes, nag rely like you tube mga in ana about buhaton about sex, like mu ingon akong partner nga mag ingon ana ta dli nako gusto muingon ko sa iya na maka daot na sa atong sex life ana kay nakakita ko ana sa youtube na ingon ana ang benefits.
Circumstances of First Sexual Experiences	P10	Nag search ko sa google kay kadto na time na kulbaan nako ug unsa akong imnon na dli ma buros.
	P6	First time nako sa kauan kaning sex kaang dili jud nako kagustuhan gani kanaang kibali gi rape ko adto na time kay kuan man to ako edad ato na time gyud seventeen mao na akong first time
Discovery of Pregnancy	P8	Actually, kanang wala ko kabalo na buros nako ato na time kay three months gikan namo nag contact kay abi lang nako ug delay ko ug one month pero wala ko kabalo na buros na deay ko.
Social and Emotional Reactions	P4	Pag buros nako wala ko nag google ky I know naman kung unsa ang sign or symptoms after atu dedtu nako naka balo nga buros ko
	P1	Sa akung family nay uban nga mo judge sa akua ky sayu lage daw ko ni sud ana nga butang pero wala ge dedma ra nako sila.
	P5	Para sa ako is wala ky aware man sad ko sa akung ginikanan kung, ky ni ingon man sad sa ako if ma buntis ang babae ky is mag suka-suka, mahilo or something ing ana so wala nko nag search atu nga time.
	P3	Sa akong friends naay uban especially nag expect sila from me . then I

searched it from google what are the possible might happen after intercourse.

Table 2 responses highlighted the complex realities of teenage pregnancy. They demonstrate a concerning lack of access to reliable sexual health information, with young people relying on friends or potentially inaccurate online sources. The circumstances of first sexual experiences suggest vulnerability, either through sexual violence or unplanned encounters, likely due to insufficient education or decision-making power. The mixed emotions reflected – from fear to indifference underlines the complex feelings teenagers may experience. Notably, the presence of judgment from family members emphasizes the persistent social stigma attached to teenage pregnancy. These insights point to the critical need for improved sex education, access to contraception and healthcare services, and open, non-judgmental support systems for young people.

The provided responses echo the findings of Risenga and Mboweni (2022) regarding teenage pregnancy experiences. Both the responses and the study highlight a lack of reliable sexual health information, the potential for vulnerability in young people's first sexual encounters, a complex range of emotions surrounding pregnancy, and the presence of social stigma. This analysis reinforces the findings of Risenga and Mboweni (2022). It emphasizes the urgent need for improved sex education, access to contraception and healthcare, and non-judgmental support for teenagers to address the complexities of teenage pregnancy.

Table 3. *Coping Mechanisms of College Students*

THEME	SUB-THEMES	PARTICIPANTS	VERBATIM RESPONSES
Advice Regarding Sex (particularly focused in per-marital sex)	Self-Control and Limitation	P5	Know your limit when it comes to sex because what if you will get pregnant, who knows you are happy now but in another day your suffering.
		P8	My advice is that they should control it.
		P10	E control ang mga butang ug I respeto ang imong partner.
	Consequences and Unplanned Pregnancy	P2	Maybe I can share strategies may be not strategies but advices to- if you are not ready especially financially about having a family do not go into such thing.
		P9	If you are going to do it we should plan it because if you are pregnant at least you are ready protection and boundaries.
		P6	So, you should know about sexual boundaries because there are many

		KMRJ
Protection and Boundaries		consequences, so if you can't avoid it, don't have sex, but you want to use protection.
	P3	Wala wala koy ma share.
	P4	In that very moment maybe yes because at that particular moment it is somewhat part of happiness and then is his result how much you love them.
	Confusing Contradictory Statement	Our strategy is to have sex with me without control but sometimes we have sex.
	P7	
	P1	Sa ako is nag tan aw ko para naa koy idea kung unsaon jud pag kuan pag limit ana nga mga butang.

Table 3 responses demonstrate a strong focus on the topic of sex, precisely the potential consequences of unplanned pregnancy, and the need for responsible decision-making. Advice ranges from advocating self-control and abstinence to emphasizing the importance of protection if engaging in sexual activity. While well-meaning, the responses suggest a need for more comprehensive sex education, as they primarily address unplanned pregnancy without broader consideration of contraception, Sexually Transmitted Infections, or emotional complexities. Some responses contain confusing or contradictory statements, potentially due to language barriers or the topic's sensitive nature.

Leekuan et al. (2021) conducted a phenomenological study exploring the narratives of pregnant adolescent women in Thailand regarding sex and contraception. Their research likely sheds light on the factors contributing to unplanned pregnancies in this population. This could highlight the need for improved access to comprehensive sex education and contraceptive services tailored to the specific needs and experiences of adolescent women in Thailand.

Table 4. *Coping Mechanisms of College Students*

THEME	SUB-THEMES	PARTICIPANTS	VERBATIM RESPONSES
Advice Regarding Sex (particularly focused in per-marital sex)	Self-Control and Limitation	P5	Know your limit when it comes to sex because what if you will get pregnant, who knows you are happy now but in another day your suffering.
		P8	My advice is that they should control it.
		P10	E control ang mga butang ug I respeto ang imong partner.
	Consequences and Unplanned Pregnancy	P2	Maybe I can share strategies may be not strategies but advices to- if you are not ready especially financially about having a family do not go into such thing.
		P9	If you are going to do it we should plan it because if you are pregnant at least you are ready protection and boundaries.
	Protection and Boundaries	P6	So, you should know about sexual boundaries because there are many consequences, so if you can't avoid it, don't have sex, but you want to use protection.
		P3	Wala wala koy ma share.
	Confusing Contradictory Statement	P4	In that very moment maybe yes because at that particular moment it is somewhat part of happiness and then is his result how much you love them.
		P7	Our strategy is to have sex with me without control but sometimes we have sex.
		P1	Sa ako is nag tan aw ko para naa koy idea kung unsaon jud pag kuan pag limit ana nga mga butang.

Table 4 presents the landscape of factors influencing young people's sexual decision-making. A strong desire for individual responsibility and autonomy emerges, with some participants emphasizing internal decision-making and disregarding external opinions. Alongside this is a clear awareness of potential risks, with respondents highlighting the importance of control and being prepared for consequences. The social

context also plays a significant role, with young people navigating community awareness, potential peer pressure, and varying levels of judgment or support. Overall, these findings underscore the need for comprehensive sexual education that empowers young people to make informed choices, manage risks, and seek support within their social environments.

Research suggests that young people navigate a complex interplay of factors when making sexual decisions. A desire for autonomy and individual control is evident, as emphasized in Lopez's (2023) study. The participants expressed a need to disregard external pressures, with one stating, "I just ignore them because I focus on my goal" (Lopez, 2023, p. 87). However, they also demonstrate an awareness of potential risks, highlighting the importance of planning and preparedness. These findings underscore the need for comprehensive sexual education initiatives that support young people as they make informed decisions while navigating social pressures and potential consequences (Lopez, 2023).

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings, the study concludes that the topic of sex presents a complex landscape for young people, as they navigate both external pressures and internal conflicts that influence their comfort in discussing sexual matters and making informed choices. Societal judgment and scrutiny act as significant barriers, often discouraging open dialogue and access to reliable information, which can impede healthy sexual development.

Consequently, there is a clear need for comprehensive sex education that equips young people with the knowledge and skills necessary to make responsible decisions, understand consequences, and communicate effectively, ultimately empowering them to exercise agency over their sexual lives with confidence and awareness.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the results and findings of the study, it is recommended that stakeholders develop initiatives that address the complex interaction of social pressures, sexual decision-making, and the effects of societal judgment on young people. Awareness campaigns should be launched to provide accurate sexual health information, dispel myths, and promote a shame-free environment that encourages open dialogue. Comprehensive sex education programs, grounded in research on social norms and peer influences, should be implemented to empower youth to make informed and responsible decisions about their sexual health.

These programs must be age-appropriate, medically accurate, and delivered in safe, supportive classroom settings where students feel comfortable asking questions and discussing concerns. Additionally, efforts should be made to help young people understand their own values and boundaries, while designing and testing interventions aimed at reducing judgment and fostering agency in making healthy sexual choices.

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Marketing Strategy and Customer Loyalty Among Fashion Retail Industry

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ABSTRACT

Marketing strategies and customer loyalty in the fashion retail sector of Butuan City, this research underscores the significant impact of well-executed marketing on fostering a loyal customer base. This study determined the marketing strategy and customer loyalty among fashion retail industry. This study used a descriptive correlational research design and was conducted in Butuan City, the respondents of the study were the fashion retail customers in Butuan City. There were one hundred (100) customers surveyed to get their perception. Quota sampling technique was used since only the available customers considered as respondents of the study during the distribution of the questionnaire. The study used a modified survey questionnaire. The following statistical tools were used to treat the problem posted in the study. Frequency and Percentage, Mean, and Pearson-r in treating the problem in this study. The study found out that marketing strategies and customer loyalty within the fashion retail industry reveals a significant interrelationship between effective marketing practices and enhanced customer loyalty. The findings indicate that well-structured loyalty programs, characterized by personalized rewards, emotional engagement, and unique benefits, play a crucial role in fostering repeat purchases and brand advocacy. Furthermore, the research highlights the importance of omnichannel strategies that create seamless shopping experiences, thereby deepening customer engagement and increasing lifetime value. the study emphasizes that a strategic approach to marketing—one that prioritizes customer engagement, emotional connections, and personalized experiences—will not only enhance customer loyalty but also contribute to long-term business success in the competitive fashion retail landscape

Keywords: *Reward structure, design, benefits, engagement, repeat purchase, lifetime-value, behavior, and advocacy, Philippines*

INTRODUCTION

The study is crucial due to the highly competitive nature of the fashion retail sector (Chaudhry et al., 2021). Understanding the relationship between marketing strategies and customer loyalty can provide valuable insights for fashion retailers to enhance their marketing efforts and improve long-term profitability. By identifying effective marketing strategies that foster customer loyalty, retailers can strengthen their brand reputation, increase customer lifetime value, and gain a competitive advantage in the market (Kim & Kim, 2023).

Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173) provides the legal framework for the collection, processing, and storage of personal data. Fashion retailers must comply with the data privacy laws when implementing marketing strategies and building customer relationships (National Privacy Commission, 2019). This includes obtaining informed consent from customers, ensuring data security, and providing transparency regarding the use of personal information. Adherence to data privacy regulations is essential to maintain customer trust and avoid legal penalties (Philippine Statistics Authority, 2021).

While studies have explored the relationship between marketing strategies and customer loyalty in various international contexts, there remains a need for further research to address specific gaps. In the United States, studies have primarily focused on the effectiveness of traditional marketing channels (e.g., advertising, promotions) in driving customer loyalty (Kim & Kim, 2023). However, there is a dearth of research investigating the impact of digital marketing strategies (e.g., social media, content marketing) on customer loyalty in the fashion retail industry. Similarly, in Singapore and China, existing studies often concentrate on the role of product quality and customer service in fostering loyalty, but there is a lack of empirical evidence examining the effectiveness of marketing strategies in driving customer loyalty and reducing churn rates (Chaudhry et al., 2021).

Furthermore, international research has largely overlooked the role of cultural factors in shaping customer preferences and responses to marketing strategies. While cultural differences may influence customer expectations and perceptions of brand value, these factors have not been adequately explored in existing studies. Understanding how cultural nuances impact customer loyalty can provide valuable insights for fashion retailers operating in diverse markets.

In the Philippines, research on the relationship between marketing strategies and customer loyalty in the fashion retail industry is limited, particularly in terms of the effectiveness of digital marketing strategies. While some studies have examined the preferences and perceptions of Filipino consumers regarding marketing communications, there is a lack of empirical evidence demonstrating the impact of digital marketing

strategies on customer loyalty and reducing churn rates. Moreover, existing research has not adequately addressed the challenges and opportunities faced by Filipino fashion retailers in implementing effective marketing strategies, such as the high cost of customer acquisition and the prevalence of online shopping.

There is no existing research on the relationship between marketing strategies and customer loyalty in the fashion retail industry specifically within Butuan City. This absence of empirical data presents a significant gap in the literature. Given the unique characteristics of the Butuan City market, such as consumer demographics, economic conditions, and competitive landscape, it is crucial to conduct research tailored to the local context. By exploring the effectiveness of different marketing strategies in Butuan City, fashion retailers can gain valuable insights into the preferences and behaviors of local consumers, enabling them to develop targeted marketing campaigns and improve customer loyalty.

The fashion retail industry was highly competitive, with numerous brands vying for consumer attention. Customer loyalty was crucial for long-term success in the industry. Marketing strategy emerged as a strategic tool to foster customer loyalty and encouraged repeat purchases. The study aimed to investigate the effectiveness of marketing strategy in driving customer loyalty within the fashion retail industry. By examining the factors that influenced consumer participation in marketing strategy and their impact on purchase behavior, the research provided valuable insights for fashion retailers sought to enhanced their customer retention strategies. The study aligned with the business research curriculum of the business administration major in marketing, as it focused on understanding consumer behavior, market dynamics, and the application of marketing strategies to achieved business objectives.

FRAMEWORK

The study anchored on the Social Exchange Theory (Thibaut & Kelley, 1959). Social Exchange Theory posits that individuals engage in relationships based on a cost-benefit analysis. People were continued a relationship if the perceived benefits outweigh the costs. In the context of brand loyalty programs, customers exchanged their loyalty and repeated businesses for rewards, benefits, and exclusive access against the perceived costs (time, effort, financial commitment) of participating. The perceived benefits outweigh the perceived costs, customers were more likely to remained loyal to the brand. The theory suggested that customers were rational actors sought to maximized their rewards while minimizing their costs. They were continued participating in a brand loyalty program, they believed that the rewards they received were fair and equitable, and the program was easy to used and understand. Moreover, Social Exchange Theory emphasized the importance of reciprocity in relationships. Customers expected to be rewarded for their loyalty, and they were remained loyal that their contributions were

valued and appreciated. Social Exchange Theory was directly relevant to the study because it provided a framework for understanding the factors that influenced customer loyalty within brand loyalty programs. The perceived benefits and costs associated with these programs, researchers gained insights into why customers chose to remain loyal to certain brands and not others. The theory helped to explain why customers were remained loyal to brands that offered valuable rewards, were perceived as fair and equitable, and were easy to use. It highlighted the importance of reciprocity in building customer loyalty. Figure 1 presented the research paradigm of the study. It outlined several variables that influenced these two key outcomes, including marketing strategy, reward structure, design, benefits, engagement, customer loyalty, repeat purchases, life time value, behavior, advocacy, and recommendation. The framework suggested that well-designed marketing strategy could foster customer loyalty, leading to increased customer retention and advocacy. However, the potential influence of recommendation highlighted the complexities of customer loyalty and the importance of tailoring loyalty strategies to specific customer segments and market conditions.

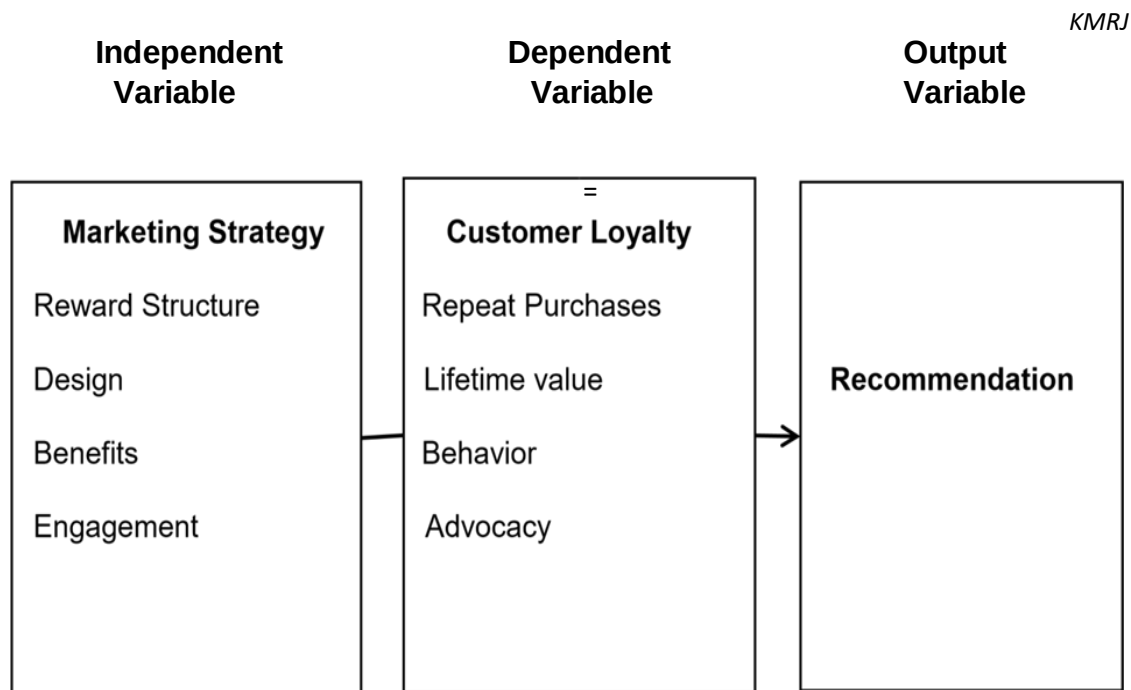


Figure 1. Research Paradigm of the Study

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study pursued to determine the following objectives: (1) to assess the level of marketing strategy (2) to determine the extent of customer loyalty (3) to investigate if there is a significant relationship between the level of marketing strategy and customer loyalty.

METHODOLOGY

This study used a descriptive correlational research design and was conducted in Butuan City, the respondents of the study were the fashion retail customers in Butuan City. There were one hundred (100) customers surveyed to get their perception. Quota sampling technique was used since only the available customers considered as respondents of the study during the distribution of the questionnaire. The study used a modified survey questionnaire. The following statistical tools were used to treat the problem posted in the study. Frequency and Percentage, Mean, and Pearson-r in treating the problem in this study. The study found out that marketing strategies and customer loyalty within the fashion retail industry reveals a significant interrelationship between effective marketing practices and enhanced customer loyalty. The findings indicate that well-structured loyalty programs, characterized by personalized rewards, emotional engagement, and unique benefits, play a crucial role in fostering repeat purchases and brand advocacy. Furthermore, the research highlights the importance of omnichannel strategies that create seamless shopping experiences, thereby deepening customer engagement and increasing lifetime value. the study emphasizes that a strategic

approach to marketing—one that prioritizes customer engagement, emotional connections, and personalized experiences—will not only enhance customer loyalty but also contribute to long-term business success in the competitive fashion retail landscape. Brands that embrace these insights are likely to cultivate a loyal customer base that advocates for them, ultimately driving sustained growth and profitability.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Summary Table of the Marketing Strategy

Marketing Strategy	Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
Reward Structure	4.11	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Design	3.97	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Benefits	4.07	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Engagement	3.87	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Overall mean	4.00	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.

Legend: 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree, 3.41-4.20 Agree, 2.61-3.40 Neutral, 1.81-2.60 Disagree, 1.0-1.80 Strongly Disagree

Table 1 summarizes the level of marketing strategy across various dimensions namely: reward structure, benefits, design and engagement with mean rating of 4.11, 4.07, 3.97 and 3.87 verbally described as “Agree”. This indicates that “The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations”. The overall mean score of 4.00 verbally described as “Agree” with indicating “The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations”. This suggests that the overall marketing strategy is perceived as effective and well-received by the respondents.

Summary table of the Customer Loyalty

Customer Loyalty	Mean	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
Repeat Purchases	3.99	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Lifetime Value	3.99	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Behavior	3.91	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Advocacy	3.90	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.
Overall Mean	3.95.	Agree	The respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations.

Legend: 4.21-5.0 Strongly Agree, 3.41-4.20 Agree, 2.61-3.40 Neutral, 1.81-2.60 Disagree, 1.0-1.80 Strongly Disagree

Table 2 shows a summary of the respondents' perceived level of customer loyalty across various dimensions, namely: repeat purchases, lifetime value, behavior and advocacy with mean rating of 3.99 , 3.99 , 3.91 , and 3.90 respectively, and verbally described as agree. This indicates that the respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations. The overall mean score of 3.95 indicates a general level of agree with indicating the respondents selecting this option mostly agree with the statement with minor reservations. This suggests that the brand is moderately successful in fostering customer loyalty and satisfaction. The findings align with this research, suggesting that the brand's offerings and customer experiences are perceived as valuable and effective in driving customer loyalty according to (Kim et al, 2021).

Table 3

Correlation Analysis Between Marketing Strategy and the level of Customer Loyalty.

Indicators		Repeat Purchase	Lifetime Value	Behavior	Advocacy
Reward Structure	Correlation Coefficient	.038	.306	.369	.043
	P-value	.707	<.001	<.001	.070
	Decision	Accepted	Rejected	Rejected	Accepted
	Interpretation	Not Significant	Significant	Significant	Not Significant
Design	Correlation Coefficient	.473	.415	.342	.774
	P-value	<.001	<.001	<.001	.029
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Benefits	Correlation Coefficient	.488	.388	.388	.291
	P-value	<.001	<.001	<.001	.003
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant
Engagement	Correlation Coefficient	.447	.654	.526	.427
	P-value	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001
	Decision	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected	Rejected
	Interpretation	Significant	Significant	Significant	Significant

Table 3 reveals the relationship between reward structure and customer loyalty. The computed r-value are the following .369 and .306 respectively indicating with a low positive correlation, while the advocacy and repeat purchases with the computed r-value of .043 and .038 with the very low positive correlation. This means that the higher the level of the reward structure has the higher the extent customer loyalty. On the other hand, the following computed p-value of behavior and lifetime value are <.001 significantly lesser than 0.05, this means that there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. There is significant relationship between reward structure and customer loyalty on lifetime value and behavior. While the repeat purchases and advocacy with the computed p-value of .707 and .670 respectively are greater than 0.05, this means there is no enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. There is no significant relationship between reward structure and customer loyalty on repeat purchases and advocacy, while the advocacy and repeat purchases has no significant, this is aligned on the study of (Kim et al. 2021). presented the significant relationship between Design and Customer Loyalty. The computed r-value of repeat purchases, lifetime value and behavior with the following,

.473, .415, and .342 respectively indicating a low positive correlation, while the advocacy with the computed r -value of .774 indicating a high positive correlation. This means that the higher level on design the higher the customer value. Moreover, the computed following p -value of repeat purchases, lifetime value, and behavior are the same $<.001$, and for advocacy of .029. All the p -value of the indicators are all less than 0.05, this means that there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis significantly lesser than 0.05. There is significant relationship between design and customer loyalty, in the study of Kim et al (2021) found that a loyalty program with a higher reward structure can positively impact customer loyalty, especially in terms of repeat purchases and customer. Revealed the relationship between benefits and customer loyalty. The computed r -value of repeat purchases, lifetime value, and behavior with the following .488, .388, and .388 respectively indicating a low positive correlation, while the advocacy with the computed r -value .291 indicating a very low positive correlation. This means that the higher level on benefits the higher the extent customer loyalty. On the other than, the computed p -value of repeat purchases, lifetime value, and behavior are the same $<.001$, while for advocacy .003. All the p -value of the indicators are all less than 0.05, this means there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. There is significant relationship between the level of marketing strategy on benefits and the extent of customer loyalty.

These findings are consistent with recent studies, such as those by Singh and Verma (2021), which emphasize that repeat purchases are more directly influenced by tangible benefits, while intangible benefits like advocacy require stronger emotional and experiential engagement. Similarly, Smith and Johnson (2023) highlight the importance of value perception in enhancing lifetime value and behavioral loyalty. Revealed the significant relationship between engagement and customer loyalty. The computed r -value of lifetime and behavior are 0.654 and 0.526 respectively suggest as moderate positive correlation, while the computed r -value of repeat purchase and advocacy are 0.447 and 0.427 respectively suggest a low positive correlation. This means that the higher the engagement the higher the customer loyalty. The corresponding p -value for all indicators are $<.001$, which is less than 0.05, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. There is significant relationship between the level of marketing strategy on engagement and the extent of customer loyalty. This analysis aligns with the findings of recent studies by Kim et al. (2021), which highlight that customer lifetime value is a critical determinant of loyalty, as it reflects sustained engagement and financial contributions. Similarly, Kumar and Kaushik (2021).

CONCLUSION

Based on the findings, the study concludes that the reward structure is the most effective component of the marketing strategy, highlighting the positive impact of tangible or monetary incentives on customer engagement. However, engagement itself remains

an area needing improvement, suggesting that strategies should not only reward customers but also foster deeper interaction and connection. In terms of customer loyalty, repeat purchases and lifetime value are the strongest indicators, demonstrating that consistently returning customers are vital for long-term business sustainability, while customer advocacy is comparatively low, indicating a need for initiatives that encourage customers to actively promote the brand.

The significant relationship between marketing strategies and customer loyalty underscores that well-planned and targeted marketing efforts play a crucial role in cultivating enduring and meaningful relationships with customers, reinforcing the importance of strategic alignment between marketing activities and loyalty objectives.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings of the study, it is recommended that brand managers focus on developing personalized marketing strategies that leverage data analytics to better understand customer preferences and behaviors, thereby enhancing engagement and fostering loyalty. Retailers should implement innovative loyalty programs that offer exclusive benefits and experiences while actively using social media platforms for real-time interaction and community building with customers. Loyal customers are encouraged to provide feedback on these programs and engage with brands online to strengthen connections and improve offerings.

The PECIT administration should ensure that marketing technologies remain up-to-date and well-integrated, enabling seamless communication between brands and their customers. Students can benefit from examining case studies of successful marketing strategies in fashion retail to gain practical insights into the dynamics of customer loyalty. Finally, future researchers are encouraged to explore the influence of emerging technologies, such as Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Augmented Reality (AR), on consumer behavior and brand loyalty, providing a deeper understanding of evolving trends in the fashion industry.

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Lived Experiences among Rental Property Owners

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ABSTRACT

The increasing demand for housing in rapidly urbanizing cities like Butuan has brought rental property ownership to the forefront of local economic activity. As the city continues to grow, so does the complexity of managing rental properties, making it vital to understand the lived experiences of those directly involved in this sector. The study explored the lived experiences, opportunities, and challenges faced by rental property owners in Butuan City. A descriptive qualitative research design was used, employing semi-structured interview guide to gather insights from ten rental property owners. Conducted in selected barangays—San Ignacio Pob (Brgy 15), Tandang Sora (Brgy 12), and Lapu-Lapu Pob (Brgy 8)—participants were purposively chosen for their relevant experiences in managing rental properties. Data were analyzed using coding and thematic analysis to identify key themes related to their experiences, challenges, and strategies. The study revealed that rental property ownership in Butuan City offers significant opportunities and challenges. Rental properties provide a reliable source of income, support financial stability, and present potential for business growth due to high tenant demand, particularly in urbanized areas near schools and workplaces. However, property owners face recurring issues such as tenant non-payment, behavioral conflicts, and property maintenance burdens, compounded by regulatory compliance requirements and financial constraints. While technology, particularly social media, has been beneficial for marketing and tenant acquisition, many property owners still rely on traditional networking methods.

Keywords: *challenges, rental property owner, lived experiences, opportunities, descriptive, Philippines.*

INTRODUCTION

The study of lived experiences among rental property owners in Butuan City is crucial for understanding the dynamics of the local rental market and identifying potential areas for improvement. This research can shed light on the factors influencing rental prices, tenant behavior, and the overall profitability of homeownership as a rental investment (Alburo, 2019). By examining the experiences of property owners, policymakers can gain valuable insights into the challenges they face and develop targeted interventions to address their needs and support the growth of the rental housing sector (National Housing Authority, 2024).

The study's legal basis can be anchored in several Philippine laws and regulations governing the rental housing sector. The Civil Code of the Philippines provides the foundational framework for owner-tenant relationships, outlining the rights and obligations of both parties (Republic of the Philippines, 1949). Specific laws such as the Residential Act of 1980 (Republic Act No. 6552) and the Rent Control Act of 1980 (Republic Act No. 6552) further regulate rental agreements, particularly in urban areas. These laws aim to protect the interests of tenants while ensuring that owners receive fair returns on their investments. By understanding the legal landscape, owners can navigate their rights and responsibilities more effectively and contribute to a stable rental market (Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development, 2021). At the international level, research on the lived experiences among rental property owners has largely focused on developed economies such as the United States, Singapore, and China. Studies in these countries have explored issues like rental market dynamics, tenant-landlord relationships, and government policies (Lee, et al. 2021).

However, there is a dearth of comprehensive research examining these aspects in developing countries, particularly in rapidly urbanizing cities like Butuan City. This gap in international literature highlights the need for comparative studies to understand the unique challenges and opportunities faced by rental property owners in different economic and cultural contexts. Furthermore, existing international research often overlooks the specific challenges faced by rental property owners, who may operate outside of formal legal frameworks and lack access to institutional support. In many developing countries, informal rental markets are prevalent, and owners in these markets may face unique challenges related to property rights, tenant protection, and economic instability (World Bank, 2022). Addressing this gap in international literature is essential for developing effective policies and interventions to support both formal and owners.

While there has been some research on the Philippine rental housing market, studies often focus on specific urban areas like Manila and Cebu. There is a lack of comprehensive research on the opportunities and lived experiences among rental property owners. This gap in Philippine literature limits our understanding of the unique dynamics of the rental market in these regions and the specific needs of owners operating in these contexts. Additionally, existing studies often focus on the perspective of tenants rather than owners, neglecting the experiences and challenges faced by property owners (National Housing Authority, 2023).

At the local level, there is a significant gap in research specifically addressing the opportunities and challenges experienced by rental property owners. While there may be

anecdotal evidence and limited local studies, a comprehensive and systematic investigation of this topic is lacking. This gap limits our understanding of the unique factors influencing the rental market in Butuan City, such as local economic conditions, demographic trends, and cultural norms. By addressing this gap, researchers can provide valuable insights to policymakers, owners, and tenants, contributing to the development of more effective policies and strategies for the rental housing sector in Butuan City.

The study of lived experiences among rental property owners in Butuan City was essential for Business Administration majors in Marketing students for several reasons. First, understanding the dynamics of the local rental market provided valuable insights into consumer behavior and preferences. By examining the factors that influenced rental decisions and tenant behavior, students gained a deeper understanding of the needs and desires of potential customers. Second, the study offered valuable practical knowledge for aspiring real estate professionals. By exploring the challenges faced by owners and the strategies they employed to overcome them, students could develop essential skills in property management, tenant relations, and investment analysis. Finally, this research contributed to the development of more effective marketing strategies for the rental housing sector. By identifying the key opportunities and challenges facing owners, students could help create targeted marketing campaigns that addressed the specific needs and concerns of this important demographic.

FRAMEWORK

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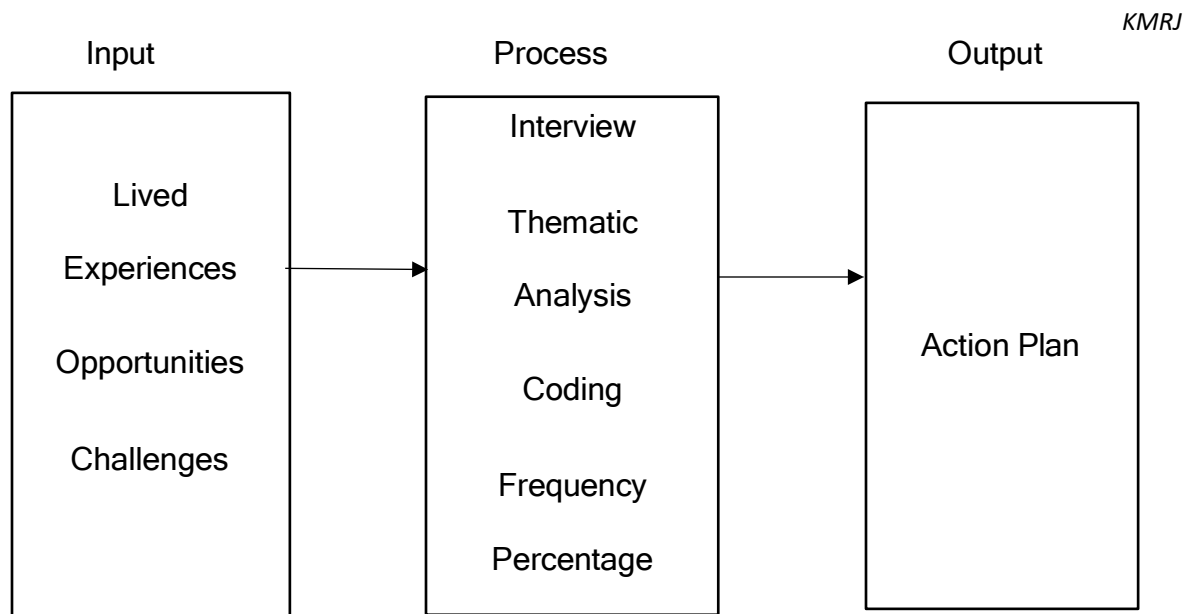


Figure 1 Research Flow of the Study

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

This study aimed to analyze how a rental property owner navigated the opportunities and challenges encountered in managing their property. Specifically, it sought to (1) to identify the opportunities experienced by the rental property owner, (2) to determine the challenges faced in the course of managing the property, and (3) to examine the strategies employed by the owner to cope with these challenges. Furthermore, it aimed (4) to formulate a plan of action based on the findings to assist current and prospective rental property owners in addressing similar circumstances.

METHODOLOGY

This study utilized a descriptive research design to investigate the experiences of rental property owners in Butuan City, focusing on the opportunities, challenges, and coping strategies in managing their rental businesses. The study was conducted in selected barangays within Butuan City—San Ignacio Pob (Brgy 15), Tandang Sora (Brgy 12), and Lapu-Lapu Pob (Brgy 8)—chosen for their significant economic growth and evolving rental market dynamics. Ten rental property owners were selected through purposive sampling, as they were the most relevant participants for this research, providing direct insights into the local rental market. Data were gathered through face-to-face interviews using a semi-structured interview guide, which allowed for flexible, in-depth exploration of the participants' experiences. The data were transcribed and analyzed using thematic analysis to identify key themes, with frequency percentage used to measure participant distribution across the barangays. Ethical considerations were upheld, ensuring informed consent and confidentiality, with the study aimed at

contributing valuable insights into the challenges and opportunities faced by rental property owners in Butuan City.

RESULT AND DISCUSSION

Table 1
Identified Opportunities as Rental Property Owner

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Income Generation and Financial Stability	P ₁	Aw, dako kaayu ug katabang.
	P ₃	Para pang bayad ng electricity at water bill maam.
	P ₄	Income!
	P ₆	Maka kwarta, usahay makabayad usahay dili, kana ilang abang pambayad suga og tubig, Ang subra gamay pang kunsomo sa mga Bata.
	P ₈	Sa Ako kibalang kaugalingon makatabang Siya, makatabang parte sa bayronon sa kuryente, sa tubig ohh, Ako diko makakuan sa kanang makasulbad cya sa problema nga dinagko nga kuan Kay di man ko daghan ug kuan Ako nagpapuyo lang ko para nga kibali Ang akong tubig ug suga ma kuan bitaw nga naay income kada bulan Ang kani ilang gibayad sa ako gikuan jud nako makasubra man pero dli ingun kibali nga makasubra jud ug dako Kay pila rmn kabuok sila hmm.
	P ₁₀	Ang sa ako kuan ged kang maka kwarta mao ged na ang kang ma kuha nako na opportunities basta ga paabang ka.
Demand from Tenants	P ₂	Kuan man gyud, Butuan City kaun man jud siya nahimutang as kanang center siya all over caraga murag ang anhianan specially sa mga students kay naay mga universities dinhi nga quality pud ang education. So, advantage sa usa ka home for rent owners pariha nako nga maka established ug business nga engon ani, ah kung sa kuan pa in demand siya. Labi na karun dili lang

			kay para sa studyante, kung para sab sa tarabahante.
		P ₇	Sa akong nakitang oportunidad kung sa mga rent owner og Balay kanang naa doul sa mga skwelahan or mga trabahoan, daghan man gyud mangita nga mga studyante og kanang ilang ka boardingan, mga trabahante pod kung asa dapita sila mag board.
Business Potential	Growth	P ₅	Ang opportunity kanang maka kuan maka income, maka income me. Maka earn me ug income. Nag pa rent me unya nka tabang pud me sa mga boarders nga kanang nag kuan sila trabahu sila naay comfortable ilang board.
		P ₉	Kuan ang pinaka nakita jud nako na opportunity sa pagpaabang kay income.

Table 1 presented the identified opportunities as a rental property owner.

Income Generation and Financial Stability. Highlights the potential of rental properties to provide a steady source of income, contributing significantly to financial stability. Participants emphasized that renting out property helps cover essential expenses, such as electricity and water bills, and provides a regular income stream. This finding aligns with previous studies on the socio-economic impact of real estate investments, where rental property is described as a reliable source of passive income, especially in developing economies (Mwaura & Akinyi, 2021). The rental business offers opportunities for stable cash flow, which can enhance economic resilience and serve as a buffer against financial shocks (Mwaura & Akinyi, 2021)

Noted the demand for rental spaces, particularly in urban areas near educational institutions and employment centers. This demand creates a favorable environment for rental business growth. Recent studies have supported this finding, suggesting that urbanization and migration trends increase the demand for rental housing (UN-Habitat, 2020). High demand ensures consistent occupancy rates, translating into sustained business viability.

Business Growth Potential. The potential for expanding rental properties into larger business ventures, such as developing multiple boarding houses, was recognized. This growth potential reflects the scalability inherent in property investment and has been described by (Adams et al. 2020) as a cornerstone for building wealth and expanding market influence in real estate.

In conclusion, the opportunities available to rental property owners primarily revolve around consistent income generation, meeting tenant demand, and the potential for business growth. This highlights the viability of rental businesses as both a steady source of income and a means to achieve long-term financial stability. Effective management and strategic reinvestment in expanding business assets can further enhance these opportunities. As evidenced by recent studies, these opportunities align

with broader economic trends in urban areas where housing demand continues to grow, providing a resilient and scalable revenue stream for property owners.

Table 2

Leveraged Technology to Improve Rental Business

Themes		Codes	Verbatim Responses
Use of Social Media		P ₂	Naga post ko online nakagamit ko butuan city home for rent naay mga groupsman jud sa facebook nga naga cater ug kanang mga engon ani gani na mga businesses so didto pud naga scroll ang nanggita ug mga kwartu nga giparentahan within butuan city
		P ₅	Oh, kuan kanang naay available nga room picturan unya e post dayun sa facebook. Availble room unya ana monthly pila ang rent every month pakita ang details nga free water and electricity. Aw oh makatabang jud ang technology kay moabot man sa uban para pud sa mag nag rent kanang nangita ug room oh dili na kinahanglan e shagit pa sa karsada sa technology nalng nimo e post ma view naman nila mas maka acces ka dali ka maka access, dakog katabang ang technology gyud.
		P ₉	Usahay mag post ko gamit akong account sa fb nga naa koy available room for rent.
		P ₁₀	Ohh, mag gamit man kong kay usahay maka kuan man me maka kaun, mag post basta Naa pay bakante ingon ana.
Minimal/No Technology	Use of	P ₁	Oh, nakatabang kay naa may mag inquire dayun nako nga mo renta.
		P ₆	Wala, mag hulat rag naay mangita, ingon ko uy naa pay bakante nga kwarto.
		P ₈	Sa Ako kibaling kaugalingon makatabang Siya, makatabang parte sa bayronon sa kuryente, sa tubig ohh, Ako diko makakuan sa kanang makasulbad cya sa problema nga dinagko nga kuan Kay di man ko daghan ug kuan Ako nagpapuyo lang ko para nga kibali Ang akong tubig ug suga ma kuan bitaw nga naay income kada bulan

Ang kani ilang gibayad sa ako gikuan jud nako makasubra man pero dli ingun kibali nga makasubra jud ug dako Kay pila ra man kabuok sila hmm.

Reliance on Referrals and Networking through Existing Tenants	P ₃	Through naay mga recommend sa mga boarders nako nga naka board na diri maam.
	P ₄	Kuan ra kanang uban chat lang, naay recommend kay kanang sa pikas kwartu naay mga amigo nangita morent dili lang kaayu mogamit mga social media kaayu ana.
	P ₇	Wala na, Kay naa man gyuy mga boarders nako dre nga sila poy maka ingon ba nga didto sa amoa Kay bakante pa naa pay ka boardingan pa didto, mga boarders lang ang mangistorya.

Table 2 showed leveraged technology to improve the rental business.

Use of Social Media. Participants frequently used social media platforms like Facebook to advertise vacancies, reflecting a modern approach to marketing. Social media facilitates broad reach, cost-effective advertising, and real-time communication with prospective tenants. A study by Mangold and (Faulds 2020) noted that social media served as an essential tool for small businesses, offering enhanced visibility and interaction with clients. For rental businesses, online promotion streamlines tenant acquisition, reducing reliance on traditional advertising methods.

Minimal/No Use of Technology. Despite the advantages of online tools, some participants still rely on referrals and traditional networking. This may reflect limited digital literacy or access. The potential benefits of increased digital engagement, particularly for small-scale owners, have been underscored by (Huang 2022), who found that technology adoption can significantly reduce vacancy periods and enhance tenant satisfaction.

In conclusion, the adoption of technology, particularly social media platforms, has proven to be a significant driver of success for many rental property owners, enabling efficient marketing and tenant engagement. However, reliance on traditional networking persists, suggesting a gap in digital adoption for some. This dichotomy highlights the importance of increasing access to digital tools to improve competitiveness and reduce vacancy periods. Leveraging online tools can streamline operations, boost market reach, and enhance customer satisfaction.

Table 3
Potential Future Opportunities for Rental Property Owners

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Continued Income and Business Expansion	P ₂	Sympre, kuan man jud ang rental business man jud dili siya gastu, aw gastu siya sa capital sa permero pero in the long run maka bawi man jud ka kaayu so nag ka dugay nag kadugay magkadaku imong income labi na ug mabawi na nimo ang capital nimo, ang opportunity jud niya is permente iyahang opportunities samtang naay mag renta naay opportunity.
	P ₅	In the future ba? Kuan more pa kanang for example business mani nimo no maayu imong pagdala sa imong business in the future maka pahimo pakag lain for example boarding house in the future makapahimo pakag daghan boarding house or unsa paba dinha or rooms.
	P ₉	Ang konsistent ang pagpaupa ug pag bayad sa mag rent basin mo boom akong room for rent puhon maka add kog another room ana guro.
	P ₁₀	Kuan kang maka extent ged among business puhon kang mo dako pa.
Improving Standards of Living	P ₃	Mo lambo ang negosyo nako maam.
	P ₄	Mao ra gihapon kanang income nga maka tabang sa amoang daily life daily expenses, mga bills, sa pag pa skwela.
	P ₈	Aw sa akong kabahin murag diko maka kuan nga nakatabang sa ako pagpaskwela Kay wana may nag skwela sa akua puro naman sila nanga graduate sa kuan high school ana. Oh, sa kana nalang pareha anang Ang ako jud kada buwan Ang tubig ug suga oh pero parte sa kanang konsumo murag madala na sa mga ing ana nga kuan

			bahin-bahin nalang Ang subra kibali inat inaton nalang nga maabut sunod buwan ing ana style.
Supporting Long-Term Security	Family and Financial	P ₁	Ay, dako ged ug makatabang kay syempre para sa amo dere wala man me lain income baya, kay ma income.man man me.
		P ₆	Maka help sa future sa mga Bata, Kay sa ila mana dha.
		P ₇	Ay mga posibleng mga Kuan nga kana bang makatabang puhon sa amo, ahh dli lang Kay kanang Kuan siguro mapa improve namo among kaugalingon puhon - puhon Kani among Balay nga gi pa rentahan basin ma apartment nani puhon - puhon kaloy.an sa ginoo.

Table 3 depicted the potential future opportunities for rental property owners.

Continued Income and Business Expansion. The anticipation of future growth, income stability, and the possibility of expanding rental businesses highlights the sustainable potential of property investments. Long-term capital appreciation and income growth opportunities were noted. This aligns with the findings by (Chen et al. 2021), who discussed how rental property ownership supports intergenerational wealth transfer and long-term asset value increase, especially when reinvested effectively.

Improving Standards of Living. Participants highlighted that rental income supports daily expenses and enhances the standard of living. Similar sentiments are found in studies discussing how consistent income from rental property supports household welfare, health, and education (WHO, 2020). Properly managed, this revenue can lead to meaningful improvements in quality of life.

In conclusion, the potential for continued income growth, business expansion, and improved living standards through rental property ownership emphasizes the long-term benefits of this venture. By effectively managing and reinvesting rental income, property owners can enhance their economic resilience and further capitalize on emerging opportunities. This potential is amplified in urban areas where high demand and consistent cash flow can support broader financial goals, aligning with findings in current property investment research.

Challenges

Table 4
Significant Challenges Faced by the Rental Property Owner

Theme	Code	Verbatim Responses
Tenant Issues (Late/Non-Payment, Behavior)	P ₁	Basura! Wala man ang ako lang, basura. Mo tongon man sila sa pag bayad kay kung dili mo bayad hawa, unsa diay nga daghan may nangita. Mo hatag mag ko ug chance, dili man ko maningil sa ila, sila raman pud mobayad. Pag dili gyud mo bayad abtan isa ka bulan, ide hawa lang pud mo syempre ang suga ug tubig unsa diay na, kay labi na karun january tig renue nasab sa license.
	P ₄	Kuan, kannag mga badlongon nga mga boarders. Kanang uban nga manibat ra walay bayad, naa jud na dili ma likayan ilahang mga gamit ibilin kunohay pero pag wala ka dinha balikan ra.
Property Preservation Challenges	P ₇	Ay ang mga pagsulay nga akong nahibaw.an pero wla pako naka experience ana Kay mga boutan mani akong mga boarders pero naa man gyud nay mga kana bitawang ma delay delay og bayad in.ana nay uban mga badlungon nga boarders.
Regulatory/Administrative Challenges	P ₉	Kanang makapaupa kag gahig ulo challenging kaayu dugay mo bayad, perme naay guba sa iyahang area.
	P ₂	Permit! Business permit sa city, labi na grabe sila ka kuti mangita na silag occupancy, fire something and all dili ka kakuha ug permit ug wala kay fire istinguisher, wala na survey sa bfp, wala kay fire exit, fire alarm, wala ka ana tanan wala kay permit.
	P ₅	As a rental owner maka agi pud ka sa mga kuan imong mga boarders, naa poy mga good payer, naa poy mga gahi mo bayad, unya naa poy kuan usahay naa pay sibatan raka molayas naa pay bayronon pa, naa pay for example mo due na karun unya nilayas na siya gabie nisibat na dili na

		mobayad mao ng challenges nga engon ana. Mga batsan sa boarders nga dili mo nimo ma sabot.
	P ₁₀	Kang dili ged dayon sila maka kaun og bayad, kay Naa bayay mga bills tig bulan lisod baya kang dli dayon ged sila maka bayad.
Financial Constraints and Revenue Dependence	P ₃	Yung kanang dugay mo bayad maam mga og naay nga boarders nga mo layas maonang dakong hamon nako maam unsa nalang akong ibayad sa water og electric
	P ₆	Kuan kalisod, kanang ting bayad nag tubig, nya wala pa ka abang, 1,500 ra gyud nya usahay data data lang 500.
	P ₈	Sa ako kibalì nga makuan wla man koy gika kuan sakong mga Kay mao lge na di man ko makakuan tungod sa kagamay ra nila, kibalì murag ma monitor nako sila unya, sobra sobra murag ako cguro Ang maldita hahaha ako cguro Ang maldita kuan kanang Ang akong lang adisir nako na sila kuanon murag dawaton Ako jud kibalì sila pahibal, on ug unsay akong bawal unya unsa pud kibalì Ang sa akong kabahin ug unsaon nako sila pagdala ohh Ako Silang kuanon nga Kita nag usa mn ta sa usa ka bobong usa ka kuan Ang ako lang pangayuon sa inyu nga mag sinabtanay lang ta para wla btaw lisud man kaayu nang usa mo unya di diay mo amigo lain kaayu ba mao nang nga akong kuan makasabut man pud sila sa akoang ka pobre ana hahaha.

Table 4 revealed the significant challenges faced by the rental property owner.

Tenant Issues (Late/Non-Payment, Behavior). The challenge of tenants not paying rent on time or exhibiting problematic behavior was a prevalent concern among participants. Many expressed difficulties in enforcing payment schedules, with some tenants absconding without settling outstanding dues. These issues can destabilize cash flows and strain owner-tenant relationships. Recent literature corroborates these findings, noting that rental property management often involves mitigating risks of non-payment through stricter screening measures (Greer & Smith, 2019). Effective tenant management strategies, such as clear contracts and regular communication, can mitigate these challenges (Hernandez 2022).

Property Preservation Challenges. Property owners also mentioned facing difficulties maintaining their properties due to tenant neglect or property damage. The financial burden of repairs and ensuring compliance with safety regulations can be substantial. As identified in prior studies, landlords must prioritize proactive property maintenance to retain tenant satisfaction and property value (Morales, 2020). Maintenance costs can eat into profit margins, but regular upkeep is crucial for long-term business success.

Regulatory/Administrative Challenges. Compliance with local regulations and obtaining business permits were described as challenging due to bureaucratic hurdles. Research by (Sharma 2021) notes that regulatory compliance costs and administrative complexities can be significant barriers for small-scale rental businesses, often deterring them from further expansion.

In conclusion, challenges related to tenant behavior, property preservation, and regulatory compliance underscore the complexities of managing rental properties. Effective tenant screening, proactive maintenance, and navigating regulatory frameworks are crucial to mitigating these challenges. Addressing these areas can help ensure property owners maintain financial stability, uphold property value, and foster positive tenant relationships, consistent with broader findings on rental business management practices.

Table 5
Strategies for Managing Tenant-Related Challenges

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Strict Rules Enforcement	P ₂	Ang kabilasa sa mag abang mao jud na ang problema kay naa jud,dili man jud pariho tanan ang mag abang kanang sa nag rent dili man kaayu siya lisud labi na kung ang inyuhang nag pa rent ka within a contract ka for example mag kuan ka 1 month advance 1 month deposit or bisag 1 month advance lang dili naman ka gansi ana kay naa namay mabilin kadabuan isa pud,dili gid ka engon nga malugi, walay possibility nga modagan siya kay nag bilin naman siya daan ug isa ka bulan nga wala pa na gamit. Ang problema lang jud nimo diha kung unsa ka mainampingon ang imong renter naa man jud uban nga bilasa uloron ang mga gamit, damak.
	P ₅	Ana jud sa pag sapag sa sugod palang sa pag inquire nila naa silay pangutana e storya na dayun ang tanan nga bawal ana unsay kinahanglan on due jud mobayad. Pag ang owner mag need man pd mobayad

sa mga bills tapos kanang mga challenges no.

	P ₈	Wla jd hinoon koy gikakuan parte sa mga ing ana nga mga pangutana mga kuan Kay anytime mobayad oo sila dili nako kinahanglan nga mosulti pa sa ila kana gipahibalo ko sila sa pamaagi sa pagbayad ohh nya Ang sila pud magtimaan man pud kibalid dili naman ko nga oi kuan na Nimo ato pang niaging adlaw imong buwan dili man. purya buyag kalooy sa ginoo mga buotan ni akong mga kuan.
Lax Payment Policies	P ₃	Kasagari man jud, ang number 1 nga kuan sa mga renter's kay kanang ilang mga uyab dili mosunod sa rules, pang duha sa pa bayad kanang hangyu hangyu ba kay wala pa ilang sweldo mga engon ana. Dili jud malikayan ang ma delay or ma postpone.
	P ₄	Data ra maam kay og nya about anang mag away maam ako silang ipa atubang para mag kaamigo ra sila maam samok na nga boarding house maam og naay mga bikil bikil.
	P ₇	Wala paman hino-uy nag away sa akong mga boarders, wala pako ka experience ana, sa mga delay delay og bayad naa pero Dili man gyud ingon nga madada Raman og storya natural man gyud ng ma delay delay labi na sa mga studyante.
	P ₉	Taasan nalng lagi ang pasensya kay naay uban jud late mobayad maong mosabot nalang sab ta ani. Tas kanang labi ng pasalamat nalng sab ko nga dli tanan gahig ulo ang nag renta dere.
	P ₁	Wala, Kang dili Lang ka bayad, wala paman ko ka incounter kanang mga engon ana nga mag away away.
	P ₆	Ay wala manay, wala manay tax ² dha, walay problema, ok ko sa ilaha, nakahatag man gahapon silag abangon, maka bayad man gahapon, bisag data-data lang, Ang nangabang ana guard ra baya nya napuno pod og utang, nya diha pod sa tuna mura

Mana dha Kay tulo Ramana ka kwarto tag 1500, nya subra bayad tubig, nya Ang tubig ta dagkoang bayrunon tag kapin libo Ang ilaha dha.

P10 Kaning kaning, saako dili man ged hinoon sila gapangita og away or unsa kang kuan lang ged nahhhh kang dili dayon mo bayad nya usahay pa gani kuwang2 kay mo hangyo lage sab na sunod sa nalang mga ingon ra mang gud ang kana.

Table 5 presented the strategies for managing tenant-related challenges.

Strict Rules Enforcement. Several rental property owners implemented policies requiring advance deposits or contracts to mitigate non-payment risks. They emphasized strict enforcement to maintain control over tenant behavior. Clear rental agreements outlining expectations and consequences can enhance compliance, as highlighted by (Walters 2020), who discussed the importance of legally binding agreements in fostering tenant accountability.

Lax Payment Policies. Other owners demonstrated a more flexible approach, showing leniency to tenants facing financial difficulties. This adaptive strategy may strengthen tenant-owner relationships and reduce tenant turnover. (McMillan 2019) observed that in certain markets, fostering trust and empathy with tenants improves retention rates and overall business stability, albeit at the risk of delayed income.

In conclusion, strategies to manage tenant challenges, ranging from strict rule enforcement to flexible payment policies, reflect a diverse approach to tenant management. Success in this area hinges on a balance of empathy and firm policies, tailored to market demands and tenant needs. By fostering trust and clear communication, owners can improve tenant retention and mitigate common issues, aligning with best practices highlighted in property management studies.

Table 6
Overcoming Property Management Challenges

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Financial Constraints on Repairs and Upkeep	P ₂	Sa kuan, sa kanang mga gamit diha sa among boarding house kami man jud ang nag produce ug pariha anang baldi nila, hayhayan naay kanang sa faucet isa man jud nga challenge kanang doorknob, faucet dugay nila ma storya gali pag kuan man jud labi nag kasagaran man jud nga gidawat nga renter either student or trabahante nga dili dinha mag tambay tibook adlaw kay kung tibook adlaw magansi man jud me sa kuryente ug tubig so mas maayu kanang mawala siya tibook adlaw balik ra siyag

		gabie.ang problema lang ana kay dili dayun mag abot kay usahay makauli gabie na kaayu tulog napud me, kasagaran mag abot me after 1 week dayoff nila diha rapud sila, mochat raman pud sila pag naay problema pariha atung niagi nabuto diay ang faucet didto sa amoa so nadali ra namo, amo ra dayung na ayo kay naa may naka tan.aw. P₅ So engon ana na siya imong income within a month imoha na siyang e divide mobayad ka sa buhis para sa imong building mo bayad ka sa buhis sa yuta diba mobayad ka so imong jud na siyang eh eh eh edivide nga kini nga portion e divide nimog 3 ka devide kaning isa para sa bills ang isa para nis sa buhis then ang isa savings nimo para in the future maka pahimo ug kuan kanang bag o nga additional nga business. P₁₀ Aww lisod ged mag repair labi na diya namo gekuha sab sa kita among gastuhon, nya mahal man renew2 tax.
Proactive Maintenance	P₃ Monitor maam og naay mga e repair ginagmay. P₄ Oh, naa engon ana so kinahanglan pakag kwarta para maka repair kanang mga kuan labi na kanang mao rana imong gisaligan kanang tanan din ha pa mokuha, so kung naay repairon di mag huwat rakag maka ipit ka ug extra pang repair engon ana. P₇ Aw kanang mga repairunon kinahanglan gyud na e monitor sa mga owner ng mga ilang mga boardinghouse nga naay mga repairunon, Kay usa man pod na makahatag pod og Kuan sa imong mga boarders og Kuan ba kanang nindot nga accomodation nila kinahanglan gyud na e monitor para ma repair dayun unsay mga daot daot diha mahatagan gyud siyag action. P₉ Kuan kanang naa man jud ng panghitabu <u>nga dili masayran parihas anang naay</u>	

		maguba nga part sa gipaupahan kuan aksyonan nalng dayon para dili na mo grabe. Tapos kanang pagbayad ug taxes dapat jud ontime maong ang akong renterdapat jud pod mamayad dayon.
Resource-Constrained Approach	P ₁	Kinahanglan reperon jud kay nag paabang man ka. Bahin sa taxes, ipon-ipon lang jud ka. Ug nay mga problema sa boarders sympre modool man jud na sa imo “maam naay mga guba”, cover jud na sa amo, guba nga suga ug lababo kami jud mag repair.
	P ₆	Oo kung naay subra sa ilang kuan e repair sa ilang kuan nay na buslot, oo, parehas anang pag repair sa atop, walay ika repair Kay data ra, repairen napod nya data ra, nya ting bayad napod og tubig, igo rapod epuli sa tubig Ang e bayad, oo nya Ang subra napod ana ipalit napod nilag panud.an Kay naa man dha nag kuan Ang iyang anak nag puyo.
	P ₈	Wla Pako naka experience Kay wala pa man ko naka pa repair pa sukad Kay di mani dugay pa akong kuan bag uhay pamn. Akong gipa kwrtuhan Kay tungod sa akong mga anak 8-man kabuok akong anak nya wala naman sila Kay nanga minyo edi naa na silay lain nga kuan edi Ang naa sa akong kuan imbis nga mabakante Ako nalang pa pud, a para nga Ang akong tubig suga masulbad Kay wala baya koy lain income oh hahah nahimong income tungod sa ilang ihatag sa ako ikuan pud nako sa aneco ug water district.

Table 6 presented the overcoming property management challenges.

Financial Constraints on Repairs and Upkeep. Participants noted that limited revenue often constrains their ability to undertake necessary repairs. This creates a cycle where neglected properties may lead to dissatisfied tenants and further financial strain. Studies emphasize prioritizing budgets for maintenance to uphold living standards and business values (Jones & Carr, 2019). Allocating revenue for proactive maintenance is crucial to reducing long-term costs and maintaining property appeal.

Proactive Maintenance. To address maintenance issues, some owners reported adopting a proactive approach by regularly checking for repair needs. Proactive

measures ensure tenant satisfaction and minimize long-term repair costs. (Jones & Carr 2019) highlighted the effectiveness of routine inspections in minimizing property damage and enhancing tenant satisfaction.

In conclusion, overcoming challenges in property management involves a proactive approach to maintenance, budget prioritization, and effective allocation of resources. Regular property inspections and a commitment to addressing tenant needs ensure sustained business viability. Property owners must remain adaptable and financially prudent to manage upkeep and regulatory compliance. This proactive approach aligns with findings that emphasize the importance of maintenance for retaining tenant satisfaction and property value.

Coping Strategies

Table 7
Coping Strategies for Rental Property Ownership Challenges

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Patience and Adaptation	P ₃	Dakog pasensya maam time manangement naa man jud mga boarders na mga badlongon.
	P ₄	Kaun lang kanang ang mga renters' man jud dili nimo mahibaw an ang mga batasan labi nang mag pa iso isog, kay diba naay mga kuan kanang kuan jud pasensya lang para way gobot ba, give and take pag mo hangyu sila pahangyoon.
	P ₇	Kuan lang hatag lang og Taas nga pasensya, taas nga pagsabot ba sa usag usa Kay dili manta pareha og mga Kuan sa kinabuhi, naa may uban nga medyo lisod lisod Kay naa may panahon pud nga kanang magkalisod pud baya ta pero tagaan lang pod nato bilang owner sa boardinghouse mo hatag pod tag pag sabot nila sa ilang sitwasyon, ana man gyud na Basta Kay Kuan, Kuan lang ba give and take.
	P ₈	Ahh Sa akong kabahin ampo lang jud tas ginoo Kay Kuan Ang atong kaugalingon atong ihalad sa ginooon di jud ka pasagdan tagaan jud kag mga tao nga pareha kibalì nako magpasulod kog mga tao tagaan jud kag mga tao nga musabut sa imong ka <u>pobre ohh Basta mag ampo lang jud.</u>

Prioritizing Maintenance and Savings	P ₂	Strong lang gihapon ko permente, laban permamente waman tay choice. Kwarta man atun gipangita, bisan unsay challenge atubangon
	P ₅	Aw naa raman jud nga mga challenges permamente jud bisan asa ka diba so engon ana nalang jud. Dapat pud ikaw pud nga kanang owner taas pd kag pasensya naa man oy uban labi na naay mga emergency mo engon nga dili siya maka bayad karun do dapat ikaw dili pud ka engon nga mag inistrikta dapat mo understood pud ka sa mga challenge pud sa ilang kinabuhi kung naa silay emergency engon ana ba pariha atung covid wala silay mga trabahu unsaon pag bayad sa mga renta so engon ana.
	P ₉	Lakas loob ug pasensya lang jud kay wala may hamon sa kinabuhi nga dili malampasan.
Spiritual and Emotional Resilience	P ₁	Wala man koy problema sa akong mga boarders dere, sugod pajud sauna wala jud na
	P ₆	Sacrifice gyud nako, gi sabot nako sila ba sa ilang mga kuan in.ana ra ilang trabaho.
	P ₉	Lakas loob ug pasensya lang jud kay wala may hamon sa kinabuhi nga dili malampasan.

Table 7 provided the coping strategies for rental property ownership challenges.

Patience and Adaptation. Many participants emphasized the importance of patience and adaptability when dealing with tenant-related challenges. Flexibility, empathy, and resilience are key to successful property management. These coping mechanisms reflect findings by (Harris 2021), who describes emotional resilience and adaptability as essential traits for small business owners facing economic and interpersonal challenges.

Prioritizing Maintenance and Savings. Prioritizing savings and maintenance expenditures was a common coping strategy among respondents. By ensuring financial stability and setting aside funds for repairs, owners manage challenges more effectively. This strategy aligns with financial management principles for small business resilience, as highlighted by (Williams 2020).

Spiritual and Emotional Resilience. Also played a role in participants' coping strategies, with some finding strength in their faith or inner resolve. Research shows that emotional resilience and support networks are critical for navigating small business challenges, including financial and tenant management pressures (Bennett & Kumar, 2020).

In conclusion, coping with the challenges of rental property management requires patience, adaptability, and a strong focus on financial management. Prioritizing maintenance and savings helps mitigate the impact of unforeseen issues, while emotional resilience and support systems provide a foundation for navigating complex owner-tenant relationships. Effective coping mechanisms can improve operational efficiency and foster a stable rental business environment.

Table 8

Seeking Support from Landlords, Professionals, and Organizations

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Independent Management	P ₁	Wala
	P ₂	Wala, kami lang gyud ang nag market ani among room kay kung mo tapad man jud ka sa agent mangayu man jud na sila ug percentage share monthly kung silay maka pasulod ug renter, gansi nami. Limpyo ra ilaha tapos kami. Kami lang jud alone nag market sa among room
	P ₄	Ah, wala. Wala me ana.
	P ₅	Wala man. Mag kuan ra maki pag ugnayan raka for example basin naay moanha dinhaa mangita dinhi ra sa ako kay naay availables dire.
	P ₆	Wala May organization, wala.
	P ₈	Wala man.
Informal Networking and Community Reliance	P ₉	Wala man, wala ko ana ged.
	P ₃	Wala maam
	P ₇ P ₁₀	Ay wala man wala ko nag apil apil ana. Ay wala na nami mag kuan ana kami ra pwede ra man ka mag post nya daghan sad mangita paabangan labi na shudad ni amo.

Table 8 showed, seeking support from landlords, professionals, and organizations.

Independent Management. Many participants reported managing their rental businesses independently, citing cost concerns related to hiring agents or collaborating with professional organizations. This aligns with the findings by (Brown et al. 2020), who observed that cost-conscious small-scale landlords often prefer self-management, despite potential trade-offs in time and professional support.

Informal Networking and Community Reliance. Reliance on word-of-mouth referrals and community networking was another strategy noted by participants. While this approach may offer limited reach compared to professional marketing, it often provides a more personalized touch. Networking and trust-building communities have been identified as effective business strategies for small-scale property owners (Reed, 2021).

In conclusion, while many property owners prefer self-management due to cost concerns, the potential benefits of professional support and networking remain significant. Engaging with community networks and leveraging informal channels can provide valuable referrals and tenant connections. However, the lack of professional collaboration highlights an area for potential growth and improved operational efficiency, as demonstrated by studies on collaborative and professional property management strategies.

Table 9

Balancing Rental Property Ownership with Life Responsibilities

Themes	Codes	Verbatim Responses
Time Management	P ₄	Take time nga mag kuan rajud time management.
	P ₅	Aw pag balance ana sa imong personal life ug sa imong business wala lang lahi raman jud siya pero mabalance man jud na siya kay kuan man dependi ramana sa imoha kung unsaon pag hatag ugf time example sa akua mabalance jud nako kay naa raman ko diria sa among balay unya an room for rent naa raman sab dinhia. maka access ko taga adlaw.
	P ₇	Ay time management lang, para ma balance nimo ang pangka ugalingon nimo nga panginabuhian og sa imong business pod bahin bahin lang.
	P ₉	<u>Time management kay dili man pedi mag dungan ng mga reposnsibilidad kay dili man</u>

parihas ang challenges sa personal nga kinabuhi ug isip usa ka amo.

Integration of Daily Tasks	P ₁	Okay ramana dili man problema ang boarding house, mo lempyo man jud pud na sila gud. Balance balance ra, once a week ra molimpyo kay sila man sab mo limpyo sa ilahang kwartu, ang amo lang kay sa hallway, cr. Sa ako wala man jud kay dali ra ang pag hinlo.
	P ₆	Aw nabalans Raman pod nako Kay pag wala koy trabaho mag hinlo hinlo ko diha sa ilang kuan, parehas karon wala man koy kuan mag guna guna ko dinha manghinlo, mang kuan sa ilang g abangan.
	P ₁₀	Kuang lang dali ra man hinoon kay dili man ko adlaw ² mag bantay mag kaun lang ged kang ² og adlaw na mag check kong okay ra ingon ara ged.
Delegation to Tenants or Family Members	P ₂	Work and life balance lang jud siya. With the guidance of Lord nakaya ra ang tanan, sympre imo man jud balansehon no morning oh kuan man jud dili man jud ko everyday naga visit sa kuan sa boarding house, mag visit raku murag twice a week gina check nako kay naakoy boarders nga bilasa ang mga rice cooker gipang olod na bweset, mao na.
	P ₃	Balance maam, balance management. Times manangement hahahahahaha
	P ₈	Ohh kuan lang jd kanang imo ra jud e pareha anang mag dungan ² Ang bayrunon Kay dili man lang ingun nga tubig ug kuryente Ang bayrunon naa pamay lain kung imo lang jud huna hunaon nga di jud ka pasagdan imo lang jud pangayuon sa ginoo nga unta tabangan ka nga makasulbad ka unya Ang katung mga tao nga makuan kibali sa ing ana mosabut pud sa imo para nga makalikay sa gubot makalikay sa kuan ing ana raman akong gibuhad.

Table 9 depicted the balancing rental property ownership with life responsibilities.

Time Management. Balancing personal responsibilities and rental management requires effective time management. Participants reported using strategies like designated visitation days and structured routines. Time management is crucial for maintaining a sustainable work-life balance in real estate management, as discussed (Kim & Park 2021).

Integration of Daily Tasks. Some participants integrated business responsibilities with their daily routines, allowing for seamless management of their properties and personal lives. Prior literature supports this approach, highlighting that flexible task integration can reduce stress and enhance productivity (Chan & Tan, 2020).

Delegation to Tenants or Family Members. Delegating certain responsibilities to tenants or family members was another effective balancing strategy. This reflects findings from recent studies showing how informal family and tenant involvement can enhance operational efficiency while reducing management burden (Mendez & Rivera, 2022).

In conclusion, balancing rental property ownership with personal responsibilities demands effective time management, task integration, and, where possible, delegation. The ability to blend business duties with daily life contributes to overall stability and mental well-being. Successful integration of personal and professional responsibilities, supported by a structured routine and support from family or tenants, aligns with best practices for achieving work-life balance in small-scale property management.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings of the study, the following conclusions can be drawn.

Rental property ownership in Butuan City offers significant opportunities, including steady income generation, high demand for rental spaces near strategic locations, and the potential for business expansion, highlighting its viability as a sustainable investment.

Challenges such as tenant-related issues, property maintenance, and regulatory compliance underscore the complexities of managing rental properties, which require substantial effort and resources to navigate effectively.

Property owners employ various coping strategies, including enforcing strict payment policies, maintaining flexibility with tenants, prioritizing proactive maintenance, and fostering resilience, all of which contribute to mitigating challenges and sustaining their businesses.

The findings emphasize the need for a comprehensive action plan that includes improving regulatory support, encouraging collaboration among property owners, and leveraging technology to enhance management practices, ensuring the long-term growth and stability of the rental market in Butuan City.

RECOMMENDATION

In light of the insight gained from this study on the lived experiences of rental property owners, the following recommendations are put forth to various stakeholders.

Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD). Develop policies that streamline regulatory requirements, such as permit acquisition and compliance with safety standards, to support small-scale rental property owners. Providing workshops or training programs on legal and management practices would help landlords navigate challenges more effectively.

Department of Trade and Industry (DTI). Encourage entrepreneurial support programs tailored to rental property owners, including access to financial tools like grants or loans to assist in property maintenance and expansion. Promoting the integration of digital tools for advertising and tenant management can further enhance their business operations.

Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG). Collaborate with local government units to implement community-based rental housing initiatives that foster better owner-tenant relationships and ensure compliance with rental housing regulations. Local ordinances could also be simplified to reduce administrative burdens for rental property owners.

Rental Property Owners. Encouraged to adopt proactive management practices, such as routine maintenance and clear rental agreements, to address tenant and property issues effectively. Leveraging technology for marketing and tenant communication is recommended to improve efficiency. Joining associations or networks of property owners can also facilitate resource sharing and collective problem-solving.

Real Estate Professionals. Focus on providing consultancy services tailored to the needs of small-scale rental property owners, offering guidance on market trends, tenant management strategies, and investment opportunities. Conducting training sessions on digital marketing and property management could further enhance the owners' business acumen.

Tenants. Educate on their rights and responsibilities to foster a harmonious owner-tenant relationship. Awareness campaigns led by community organizations or housing authorities can encourage tenants to communicate openly with owners and comply with rental agreements.

Future Researchers. Explore additional aspects of rental property management, such as the socio-cultural impacts of owner-tenant interactions and the economic contributions of the rental market to local development. Comparative studies with other cities in the Philippines could provide broader insights into rental property dynamics.

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